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DiploMind: Adaptive AI-Powered International Relations Literacy Platform for Multilingual Pakistani Users

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Abstract

International Relations (IR) and current-affairs content available to Pakistani readers is overwhelmingly English-first and written to a single, undifferentiated level of depth. News coverage assumes the reader already knows the background, while think-tank and academic writing is dense and aimed at specialists. This leaves readers who are more comfortable in Urdu or Urdish (Roman Urdu), or who need more (or less) background context, poorly served, and nothing in these sources checks whether the reader actually understood what they read. DiploMind is an adaptive learning platform that personalizes both the language and the explanation depth of IR and current-affairs content to each reader, drawing on a continuously updated knowledge base spanning live news and foundational analytical sources. Explanations are generated by a language model with separate language and depth adapters, are grounded in retrieved articles, and are shown with their sources. A short onboarding quiz gives each new reader a starting profile, and short quizzes taken after the explanations measure how well the reader understood them. Unlike systems that fix a reader's profile at onboarding, DiploMind uses these quiz results to continuously refine it as a reader's needs change over time, and to detect and correct readers who were placed at the wrong language or depth.

Executive Summary

Most international relations (IR) and current-affairs content available to Pakistani readers is written in English, at a single level of difficulty, for a single kind of reader. News reports assume the reader already knows the background, and think-tank writing assumes specialist knowledge. Readers who are more comfortable in Urdu or Urdish (Urdu written in Roman script and mixed with English words), or who need more or less background than the text provides, are left to struggle or give up. Nothing in these sources checks whether the reader actually understood what they read.

We are building DiploMind, a web-based adaptive learning platform, to address this gap. A reader asks a question about International Relations through a chat interface and receives an explanation in their preferred language (English, Urdu or Urdish) and at a suitable level of depth (easy, medium or technical). Each explanation is generated from retrieved news and think-tank articles, and the sources are displayed alongside it. The reader's profile is not fixed at sign-up. Instead, short quizzes after some explanations will measure how well the reader understood it. DiploMind will use these results to keep refining its choice of language, depth and explanation style. The project falls under the NLP domain and supports SDG 4 (Quality Education).

How it works is that a knowledge base is built from scraped Pakistani and international sources in both english and urdu. When a new user arrives, he has to take a short onboarding quiz that identifies which group, out of the 9 groups, does he belong to. The 9 groups being a combination of three languages and three depths. A single base model serves all groups and six Low Rank adapters are trained separately and combined at generation time using mathematical composition operations. This avoids training nine separate models, one for each group. A contextual bandit (LinUCB) chooses the adapter pair for each reader, and it is restricted to the reader's current pair and its neighbours so that no one is shown an explanation far above or below their level. The quiz results become a reward that updates the bandit straight away. The rewards are also used by a drift monitor that compares each reader with its group and moves readers who were placed wrongly, and they are stored so that the shared adapters can be improved in batches offline.

The literature review covers sixteen papers on adapter composition, personalized alignment, bandit-based selection, corrective retrieval, multilingual and code-switched text, cold-start profiling and intelligent tutoring. Each of these techniques has been studied on its own. We found no work that combines them to personalize both language and depth for multilingual IR learners and to correct the reader's profile from comprehension results. This combination is what DiploMind contributes.

The rest of this report is organized as follows. Chapter 1 introduces the project and its audience. Chap-

ter 2 states the problem, goals and scope. Chapter 3 reviews related work. Chapter 4 specifies the requirements, use cases, interface and database design, and the risks. Chapter 5 describes the methodology, from dataset construction to adapter training, retrieval, bandit selection, reward design and drift detection. Chapter 6 presents the architecture and design of the system.

At the time of writing, the scraping pipelines have been built and are collecting articles from BBC News, BBC Urdu, Dawn, Express, Geo and ISSI. Requirements, use cases, architecture and sequence diagrams are complete, and the interface screens (sign-up, sign-in, onboarding quiz, chat and post-explanation quiz) have been designed. The main work still ahead is adapter training, integrating the bandit and drift monitor, and evaluation.

DiploMind is scoped as a working MVP that runs on a single 16 GB GPU. Voice interaction and production-scale deployment are left as future work. The main risks are the quality of LLM-generated Urdu and Urdish training data, the noise in quiz-based rewards and the compute cost of reinforcement-learning updates. We manage them through native-speaker review, difficulty-weighted rewards, simulated learners for testing, and simpler fallback options at each step. If successful, DiploMind will give Pakistani readers IR and current-affairs explanations that match their language and background, and will improve its explanations as it learns what each reader understands.

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Chapter 1 Introduction

Following international relations (IR) and current affairs matters for anyone who wants to understand what is happening in the world and how it affects their own country. In Pakistan, though, the content available for this is not written with the reader in mind. News coverage reports events and assumes the reader already knows the background. Academic and think-tank writing supplies that background, but in dense, English-only prose meant for specialists. Both produce one fixed version of their content for everyone.

This is made harder by how Pakistani readers actually use language. Many move between formal English, formal Urdu, and Urdish (Roman Urdu mixed with English, common online) depending on what feels natural. Readers also differ in how much they already know, so the same article can be too basic for one person and too difficult for another. There is no easy way to get the same content in a form that suits you, and nothing checks whether you actually understood it.

DiploMind is built to address this. It is an adaptive learning platform that gives each reader explanations of IR and current-affairs topics in the language and depth that suit them. A short onboarding quiz gives a new user a starting level. This level is not kept fixed, results from short quizzes after some explanations are used to keep adjusting it. Explanations are generated by a large language model with separate adapters for language and depth, using documents from a knowledge base collected from news and think-tank sources.

1.1 Purpose of this Document

The purpose of this document is to present our approach towards building a platform that helps Pakistani readers understand International Relations (IR) and current affairs content in their preferred language and at a level of depth they understand. It is a web based application that will help readers who find existing news and academic writing either too difficult or too basic, and also those who are more comfortable in Urdu or Urdish than in English. The main aim of this project is to develop a user-friendly MVP (Minimum Viable Product) that profiles a new reader through a short onboarding quiz, delivers explanations adapted to their language and depth, and keeps refining that profile using quiz feedback. Our project belongs to the NLP (Natural Language Processing) domain since it uses a large language model with separate language and depth adapters to generate explanations from a knowledge base of news and think-tank content. The research question that we aim to answer is: “Can we develop an adaptive platform that personalizes the language and explanation depth of IR and current-affairs content for each reader, and keeps correcting its assumptions about that reader using quiz feedback?”. This report

presents the vision, related work, requirements, proposed approach, and design of our project.

1.2 Intended Audience

This report is written mainly for our supervisor and the evaluation panel, who will judge whether the project is well defined and technically sound. For this reason, it states requirements and design decisions clearly and explains the reasoning behind them. It assumes a computer science background, but not prior knowledge of international relations or of the specific techniques used, such as adapters and contextual bandits, which are explained where they first appear.

A secondary audience is future students or developers who may extend the system, and who will mainly need the requirements and design chapters. This report is not written for the learners who will use DiploMind. They are covered as users in the requirements chapter.

1.3 Definitions, Acronyms, and Abbreviations

The important definitions, acronyms, and abbreviations used in this document are listed below:

IR: International Relations

FYP: Final Year Project

SDG: Sustainable Development Goal

LLM: Large Language Model

LoRA: Low-Rank Adaptation

LinUCB: Linear Upper Confidence Bound

GRPO: Group Relative Policy Optimization

RSS: Really Simple Syndication, a standard feed format through which websites publish their latest articles

UI: User Interface

API: Application Programming Interface

Urdish: Urdu written in Roman script and mixed with English words, as commonly used online in Pakistan

Adapter: A small set of extra trained weights added to a language model to change its behaviour without retraining the whole model

Depth: How much background and detail an explanation gives (easy, medium, or technical)

Cold start: The problem of personalizing for a new user who has no history yet

Drift: When a learner's real needs no longer match the group they were first placed in

Knowledge base: The collection of scraped articles and papers that answers are based on

1.4 Conclusion

This chapter introduced the problem of one-size-fits-all International Relations and current-affairs content for Pakistani readers, and presented DiploMind as an adaptive platform that personalizes the language and depth of explanations. The rest of this report is organized as follows. Chapter 2 states the problem, the goals and objectives, and the scope of the project. Chapter 3 reviews related work on adapter composition, personalization, bandit-based selection, retrieval, and multilingual text. Chapter 4 specifies the requirements, use cases, interface screens, database design, and risks. Chapter 5 describes the methodology, from dataset construction and adapter training to retrieval, adapter selection, reward design, and drift detection. Chapter 6 presents the architecture and design of the system, including its diagrams and design policies.

Chapter 2 Project Vision

In Pakistan, keeping up with IR and current affairs is unnecessarily difficult. Most sources present the same content in the same way to everyone, whether the reader is a first-time learner or has years of background, and whether they are most comfortable in English, Urdu, or a mix of both. As a result, many readers struggle to follow what they read, lose interest, or finish a piece without really understanding it. To address this, DiploMind which is an adaptive learning platform aims to give each reader explanations that suit their language preference and prior IR knowledge. It check their understanding through short quizzes, and keep refining what it knows about the reader over time. Our vision is to make IR and current affairs literacy more accessible and meaningful for Pakistani readers.

2.1 Problem Domain Overview

IR and current affairs content in Pakistan is written with aspecific kind of reader profile in mind, and most real readers do not match that profile. News coverage usually assumes the reader already knows the background of a story, so newcomers are left without the context they need. On the other hand, academic IR writing is dense, mostly in English, and is written for specialists rather than learners. Neither takes into account that Pakistani readers move naturally between English, Urdu, and Urdish depending on what feels comfortable.

A second gap is that these sources have no way of checking whether a reader has understood what they read. Readers can skim an article from start to finish and never find out whether they missed the point, and the source never learns whether its explanation was too difficult or too basic for them.

DiploMind is designed to close these gaps. It is a multilingual, adaptive learning platform that draws on Pakistani and international sources in English and Urdu. New readers take a short diagnostic quiz that gives them a suitable starting profile. The platform then presents content in the language and depth that fits that profile. Short comprehension quizzes are given at intervals to check understanding, and the results are used to update the reader's profile over time.

2.2 Problem Statement

Readers of IR and current-affairs content in Pakistan have no easy way to find material that matches their language comfort and background knowledge. They must choose between news that assumes prior context and academic writing that is dense and mostly in English, and neither tells them whether they have understood. The problem this project addresses is the absence of a learning experience that adapts to the reader and verifies their understanding.

2.3 Problem Elaboration

The problem described above can be broken down into the following sub-problems.

2.3.1 Scattered and Uneven Content

Material on International Relations and current affairs is spread across many Pakistani and international sources, in different languages and at very different levels of difficulty. There is little foundational content for beginners, and readers have no single place where relevant material is collected and organized.

2.3.2 Mismatch of Language and Depth

Pakistani readers move between English, Urdu, and Urdish depending on the topic and their comfort. Most content, however, is fixed in one language and assumes one level of background, so readers either struggle with it or lose interest.

2.3.3 No Starting Point for New Readers

A first-time user has no reading history, so there is no basis for judging their language comfort or how much they already know. Without a starting point, the first experience is likely to be a poor fit.

2.3.4 No Check on Understanding

Existing sources do not confirm whether a reader has understood what they read. There is no difference between skimming and truly understanding it, so neither the reader nor the publisher can distinguish between them.

2.3.5 Changing Reader Needs

A reader's language comfort and knowledge change as they learn.If we test them only once, that result soon becomes outdated, so content that suited a reader at the start may later become too easy or too difficult later.

2.4 Goals and Objectives

This section explains the overall aim of the project and its objectives.

2.4.1 Goals

The goal of this project is to make IR and current affairs content easier for Pakistani readers to access and understand. To do this, DiploMind adapts content to the language each reader is most comfortable with and their background knowledge, and then checks whether they have actually understood it.

2.4.2 Objectives

The objectives of this project are:

- To build a knowledge base of current affairs and foundational IR content that is updated regularly, using both Pakistani and international sources in English and Urdu.
- To personalize content for each reader by adjusting its language and depth according to their profile.
- a short diagnostic quiz places new users in a suitable starting profile so that the content they see initially matches their level reasonably well.
- To develop an adapter based model that can generate explanations in different registers and at different levels of depth.
- To check comprehension through periodic quizzes and use the results as a feedback loop to keep each reader's profile up to date.
- To detect when a reader's profile no longer matches their level and move them to a more suitable one.

2.5 Project Scope

The project consists of two phases, the research phase and the development phase.

The research phase involves a comprehensive literature review to gather insights and best practices from existing work on personalization and adaptive learning. Additionally, the phase involves identifying local and international sources of current-affairs and foundational IR content that will serve as the knowledge base for our project.

The second phase consists of the development stage.Our project aims to develop an adaptive learning platform for IR and current affairs literacy. To achieve this, we will build a data pipeline that collects and prepares content from these sources. We will also develop a personalization system to adapt the language and depth of this content to each reader, with new readers first taking a short diagnostic quiz. Lastly, a feedback mechanism based on periodic quizzes will be used to keep refining each reader's

profile over time.

The scope does not include voice based interaction or production scale deployment. Hence, these are left as future work.

2.6 Sustainable Development Goals

Diplomind supports Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) 4, Quality Education, shown in Figure 2.1. It adapts content to each reader's language and background and checks whether they have understood it, which makes learning about IR more inclusive and easier to access. This matters most for readers in Pakistan, many of whom are not well served by material written mainly in English.



Figure 2.1: SDG 4

2.7 Conclusion

IR and current-affairs content in Pakistan is largely written for a single type of reader and offers no way to check whether that reader has understood it. DiploMind responds to this by adapting content to each reader's language and background and by using short quizzes to keep their profile accurate over time. The project focuses on personalized content delivery with ongoing profile refinement, and it supports SDG 4, Quality Education, by making this literacy more accessible to Pakistani readers.

Chapter 3 Literature Review / Related Work

The following section reviews previous research related to the chosen topic and explains the technique used in each study in detail.

3.1 Definitions, Acronyms, and Abbreviations

The important definitions, acronyms and abbreviations used in this chapter are listed below:

PEM: Parameter-Efficient Module

(IA)^3: Infused Adapter by Inhibiting and Amplifying Inner Activations

RTE: Recognizing Textual Entailment

CMA-ES: Covariance Matrix Adaptation Evolution Strategy

MDP: Markov Decision Process

RLHF: Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback

P-RLHF: Personalized Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback

DPO: Direct Preference Optimization

P-DPO: Personalized Direct Preference Optimization

P-SOUPS: Personalized-Soups

BLEU: Bilingual Evaluation Understudy

METEOR: Metric for Evaluation of Translation with Explicit ORdering

3.2 Detailed Literature Review

This section covers notable literature published in the domains relevant to an adaptive multilingual learning platform for international relations. These include composing and routing parameter-efficient adapters for large language models to serve different languages (English, Urdu, and Urdish) and explanation depths, selecting the best adapter for each type of learner, and using reinforcement learning from learner feedback, such as quiz results, to improve tutoring systems.

3.2.1 Composing Parameter-Efficient Modules with Arithmetic Operations

A training-free method that merges separately trained LoRA modules through addition and negation in weight space, so their skills can be combined or removed without extra training.

3.2.1.1 Summary of the research item

Zhang et al. [1] propose composing PEMs, such as LoRA and $(IA)^3$, by linear arithmetic operations. They have defined two basic mathematical operators. Addition merges the parameters of two modules into one, so the new module carries the skills of both. Negation reverses a module's effect so that a learned behaviour can be removed. A weight λ controls how much each module contributes and is tuned on a validation set. The authors test four settings: distribution generalization, multi-tasking, unlearning, and domain transfer. They also extend the approach to Alpaca-LoRA, an instruction-tuned LLaMA model, to reduce toxic output. The merged modules improved on the individual modules, for example a gain of up to about 5 points on RTE when merging two LoRAs. Negating a toxic LoRA cut the toxicity score of GPT-2 from 0.10 to 0.01 with little effect on language quality.

3.2.1.2 Critical analysis of the research item

One of the strengths of this research lies in its training-free approach, which allows new capabilities to be created cheaply from existing modules, and in its practical finding on shared initialization. However, most experiments use small or mid-sized models (RoBERTa, T5, GPT-2), with only the detoxification experiment at LLM scale. The approach only works when all modules share the same architecture, and the scaling factor λ has to be tuned by hand. The tasks tested do not include combining language and writing style adapters.

3.2.1.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This paper directly supports the adapter design of our project. We train three language adapters (English, Urdu, Urdish) and three depth adapters (easy, amateur, technical) separately and combine them to cover nine user clusters. The paper shows that linear combination of separately trained LoRAs is feasible without training nine joint adapters. Its finding on shared initialization also guides how we train our adapters.

3.2.2 LoraHub: Efficient Cross-Task Generalization via Dynamic LoRA Composition

A framework that automatically combines many pre-trained LoRA modules into one, using a few examples of a new task and no gradient updates.

3.2.2.1 Summary of the research item

Huang et al. [2] introduce LoraHub, which assembles LoRA modules trained on different upstream tasks to handle an unseen task. Learning has two stages. In the Compose stage, the available LoRA modules

are merged element-wise into a single module using a set of scalar weights. In the Adapt stage, these weights are tuned on about five examples of the new task using a gradient-free optimizer (CMA-ES), with an L1 penalty to avoid extreme values. The authors use FLAN-T5-large as the base model, about 200 upstream tasks to train the modules, and 20 randomly chosen modules per run. On the Big-Bench Hard benchmark, LoraHub averages 34.7, compared with 27.0 for zero-shot and about 37.3 for few-shot in-context learning. It does this using about 112 tokens per example, against about 598 for in-context learning, because no demonstrations are needed at inference.

3.2.2.2 Critical analysis of the research item

One of the strengths of this research is how efficient it is, mainly because the weight search completely skips backpropagation and only needs about 40 extra inference steps per task. However, it doesn't beat in-context learning on average. It also falls behind standard LoRA and full finetuning if the tasks are too far off from the original training data. Results also become less stable as more modules are combined, and the evaluation covers only reasoning benchmarks, not style or language adaptation.

3.2.2.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This paper is relevant to the adapter-selection part of our project. Like our LinUCB step, LoraHub figures out how to mix several LoRA adapters together. We can use its weight search to set up an initial mix for each user cluster before we deploy the system. After that LinUCB will refine that mix using the quiz feedback from users. Their finding that having a massive pool of modules causes high variance also supports our choice of a small pool of six adapters to keep everything simple.

3.2.3 From Problem-Solving to Teaching Problem-Solving: Aligning LLMs with Pedagogy using Reinforcement Learning

An online reinforcement learning framework trains a 7B tutor LLM on simulated student dialogues, rewarding both the student's solve rate and the tutor's pedagogical quality. It raised student solve rate from 11.3% to 25.3% while cutting answer leakage from 29.3% to 10.6%.

3.2.3.1 Summary of the research item

The work of Dinucu-Jianu et al. [3] investigated how to turn a problem solving LLM into an effective tutor using online reinforcement learning. They framed multi-turn tutoring as a Markov Decision Process in which a tutor LLM (initialized from Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct) holds simulated conversations with a fixed student LLM (Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct) about math problems from the Big-Math dataset. After each conversation, the system calculates a reward based on two things: whether the student can actually solve

the problem afterward, and how good the tutor's teaching style was which is scored by a judge LLM. The reward also punishes the tutor if it just leaks the answer straight away, and a parameter λ controls the balance between learning outcomes and pedagogical quality. The study showed that training directly on these rewards lets a small open model learn to guide students step by step instead of giving away answers, without human supervision.

3.2.3.2 Critical analysis of the research item

One of the strengths of this research is how the reward is structured, which is based on what the student actually achieves after the dialogue and not only on how good the tutor's reply looks. The weight λ lets the trade off between student success and teaching quality be set explicitly, and the results show a clear balance between the two. The method also needs no human-annotated tutoring data, and it preserves the base model's reasoning ability better than supervised fine-tuning, which dropped by 7.5 points on GSM8K. However, all students and rewards are generated by LLMs, so the results have not been validated with real learners, and the use of a single student model does not reflect the variety of real students. The experiments cover only mathematics in English and use one tutoring policy for all students, so there is no adaptation to a learner's background or language. The reward is also measured right after the dialogue, so it does not capture long-term retention, and training needs substantial compute resources.

3.2.3.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

The paper relates to the reinforcement learning module of our project, which updates the model using feedback from quiz results. It supports our approach of using learner outcomes as a reward signal and balancing it against response quality. Their paper used simulated students and retrained a single model, while our system will rely on quiz feedback from users reading international relations content in English, Urdu, and Urdish. Also, instead of retraining the entire base model, our updates will just be on the shared language and depth LoRA adapters.

3.2.4 Personalized Language Modeling from Personalized Human Feedback

A technique for training one LLM to personalize its responses based on each user's feedback. It performs better than methods that ignore individual user differences, winning over 60% of comparisons on a real dataset of 1,500 people.

3.2.4.1 Summary of the research item

Li et al. [4] dicussed a problem with standard RLHF that it treats all users as if they like the same kind of answer, so the answers most people prefer win and users with different tastes are ignored. To fix this, the authors propose P-RLHF. In addition to the LLM, it trains a small user model that turns each user's information into a user embedding, which is later added to the input of the LLM so that the answer is personalized for that specific user. The user model can learn from what a user writes about themselves, and also from the user's past choices between two answers. It can treat every user as different, or place users into clusters who share similar tastes. A new user whom the model has not seen gets a general embedding that reflects the preferences common to all users. The model is trained with P-DPO and the author tested in on three tasks: a summarization task where different users have different length preferences, instruction following with 6 different preferences of users, and PRISM dataset with real users. In the first task, the model matched the user preferences 91% of the time, against 59% for DPO. In the second task it was better than 90% of comparisons against models that ignore preferences. While in the third task it was better in 60%+ comparisons against DPO.

3.2.4.2 Critical analysis of the research item

One strength of this research is its use of a small user model, so that the system doesn't need a separate LLM for each user and it can serve a large number of users as well due to less cost and clustering works too when users share same preferences. It learns preferences directly from users feedback without the need of users to explicitly state them, and it still gives good enough answers to new users who dont have any history. But the main experiment of theirs used made up preferences and in other experiments the answers were judged by a GPT-4 model, not real users, making its credibility questionable. The method learns from pair of answers collected as a dataset and doesn't use any reward signal approach that we want to incorporate. The task measures if the answers matched users prefered ones and doesn't judge the learning of the user which is a gap.

3.2.4.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This paper relates to the personalization and Reinforcement Learning part of DiploMind. The idea of placing users into a fixed set of clusters that share a common model matches our cluster based approach of 9 fixed groups ,where users in a common group each share a common adapter. It's instruction following task includes preference similar to what our depth level is.

3.2.5 ERUPD: English to Roman Urdu Parallel Dataset

A collection of 75,146 parallel sentence pairs in English and Roman Urdu, created using GPT generated text that was manually reviewed and corrected. Training a T5-Small model on this dataset resulted in a BLEU score of 39.9.

3.2.5.1 Summary of the research item

Furqan et al. [5] addresses the problem most of the people working in low resource languages, such as Urdu or roman Urdu encounter, that is not enough data availability to finetune models on. They fixed this by building a dataset for roman Urdu using GPT-3.5, GPT-3.5 Turbo instruct and Claude Opus, using few shot, zero shot, topic based and chain of thought prompting. Each prompt asked for every sentence in both English and Roman Urdu. The authors added about 10,000 sentences from an existing Roman Urdu sentiment dataset, translated into English, and real conversations from two WhatsApp groups of student volunteers. The prompts asked for English words mixed into the Roman Urdu, different spellings of the same word, and synonyms. The models did not always follow these instructions, so the authors corrected them in a human review phase. In this phase they also fixed mistakes in gender and in singular and plural verbs, and supplied sentences the models had failed to translate. The final dataset has 75,146 sentence pairs. To test it, the authors trained T5-Small and mBART, which scored 39.929 and 38.770 BLEU and 0.526 and 0.531 METEOR.

3.2.5.2 Critical analysis of the research item

One of the strengths of this research lies in its approach of generating data with strong LLMs (GPT-3.5, GPT-3.5 Turbo Instruct, and Claude Opus) and then correcting it by hand. The dataset built this way was good enough to train translation models that gave useful results, so the approach is valid for building parallel data for a low resource language. The paper also tells about the prompts the authors used and the errors the models made during generations such as hallucinations, missing translations etc so that the generation process can be repeated. The downside is that the paper is in arXiv preprint and has not yet been reviewed. The dataset is general purpose as it covers everyday things, and is not in the domain of IR content.

3.2.5.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

The paper covers the dataset creation part of DiploMind where English, Urdu, and Urdish data is created to train the language adapters. It supports our plan to generate data with an LLM and then correct it, and its list of common errors tells us what to check in our own data. While their dataset is general text in

Roman Urdu, our data comes from news articles, specifically BBC Urdu current affairs articles.

3.2.6 Personalized Soups: Personalized Large Language Model Alignment via Post-HOC Parameter Merging

A method that personalizes a language model to combinations of conflicting user preferences by training one model per preference and merging their parameters at inference time.

3.2.6.1 Summary of the research item

Jang et al. [6] address how to personalize a language model for users with different and sometimes conflicting preferences, which standard RLHF cannot handle because it learns one average preference. They define six preferences in three dimensions: expertise (elementary school or PhD level), informativeness (concise or very informative) and style (friendly or unfriendly), giving eight combinations. Using GPT-4 as a simulated annotator on 10,000 GPT4-Alpaca prompts, they train a separate Tulu-7B policy for each preference with PPO and LoRA. At inference, the policies matching the user's preferences are merged by a weighted sum of their parameters. Judged by GPT-4, this method, Personalized Soups, had the highest average win rate (55.23%) and beat the untuned model 59.86% of the time. Human judges ranked Prompted-MORL, a single model trained on all combinations, slightly higher (58.70% vs 55.29%). Adding two new style preferences needed only two new models, and Personalized Soups still won 59.06% against Prompted-MORL under GPT-4.

3.2.6.2 Critical analysis of the research item

One of the strengths of this research lies in its linear scaling, since each new preference needs only one new model and unseen combinations are composed at inference. It also showed that merging outperforms multi-task fine-tuning and that prompting alone cannot integrate multiple preferences. However, preferences are predefined, declared by the user and fixed, and the authors acknowledge that real preferences change over time but do not address it. Annotators are simulated by GPT-4, the human study has only 24 crowdworkers, the two judges disagree on the best method, and the evaluation covers only 50 prompts, one 7B model and English. Factual accuracy is not measured, the merge weights are set by hand, and it is a preprint.

3.2.6.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This research is relevant to the adapter design and composition module of our project, which trains three language adapters and three depth adapters separately and combines them to cover nine user clusters. Its expertise dimension corresponds to our depth axis, and its results support merging separately

trained adapters over prompt-based personalization. The main difference between this research paper and adapter design and composition module of our project is that they rely on fixed user preferences with English style whereas Diplomind starts with placing the users through onboarding quiz, and then using the quiz based feedback updates the adapter pair with LinUCB. It also uses drift detection to change the clusters of misplaced learners.

3.2.7 A Contextual Bandit Approach to Personalized News Article Recommendation

A Contextual Bandit Approach to Personalized News Article Recommendation is the article that includes the algorithm LinUCB that selects articles from user and learns from click feedback, together with an offline method for evaluating on logged data.

3.2.7.1 Summary of the research item

Li et al. [7] talks about personalized recommendation where collaborative filtering is difficult and where there are many new users and constant changes in news. They describe it as contextual bandit, where the algorithm keeps in check the user behavior (whether the user clicks some article) and article features. LinUCB uses ridge regression to estimate the click rate with the addition of upper confidence bound in case of uncertainty. Exploration is controlled by a single parameter, α, while a hybrid version shares some coefficients across articles. In order to do unbiased assessment without a simulator, this article proposes an offline evaluation method that examines logs collected with equally random displays and saves only those cases where the new policy fits the log. Using user features increased click rates by 10% on Yahoo! Front page data. In situations with limited data, LinUCB performed better than ε greedy.

3.2.7.2 Critical analysis of the research item

The algorithm has a fixed bound with a parameter and is easy to use. When the data is limited, its uncertainty driven exploration performs better than random exploration. It also manages new users and thus, the offline evaluation is unbiased and the reward is a click. This approach assumes constant user interests and linear feedback over built in features. As the offline evaluation requires randomly logged data and all tests come from a single news service, it was hard to fix warm starting from an offline model.

3.2.7.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This work is closely related to the adaptation module of Diplomind, which selects the language and depth adapter combination for every user group using LinUCB. It describes the approach and the role of α The hybrid model serves as backup for groups with less data. The warm start outcome warns about

how to set up each of the nine groups. The users are moved to the incorrect group by drift detection and the reward is received through quiz performance rather than clicks.

3.2.8 LPITutor: an LLM based Personalized Intelligent Tutoring System using RAG and Prompt Engineering

A tutoring system that grounds a pre trained LLM in course documents through retrieval augmented generation and personalizes its answers through learner aware prompts, evaluated on questions at beginner, intermediate and advanced levels.

3.2.8.1 Summary of the research item

Liu et al. [8] explored how to create a personalized tutoring system without the use of standard systems. This article explains the working of LPITutor, a pretrained GPT 3.5 model. In this type of system the knowledge base is created by converting the course content into vector embeddings and then saving them into a vector database. The student's query is compared to these embeddings using cosine similarity to find top passages which alongwith the users data(past knowledge, query history, and desired explanation style) are combined to form answers. Experts rated 300 questions which were divided into beginner, intermediate, and advanced levels and their accuracy scores were 97%,94% and 89%. In a comparison on undergraduate computer science questions, factual accuracy was 0.72 for the LLM alone, 0.88 for retrieval only and 0.94 for LPITutor, and satisfaction was 3.8, 3.7 and 4.6 out of 5.

3.2.8.2 Critical analysis of the research item

One of the strengths of this research lies in grounding answers in course documents with source references, and in comparing the LLM alone, retrieval only and the full system across difficulty levels. The code and data are also openly released. However, personalization happens only through the prompt, the learner profile and the adaptive feedback loop are not described or tested, and personalization is not evaluated on its own, so its contribution cannot be separated from retrieval. The system is described with GPT-3.5 but the main experiments use GPT-4, key details such as the embedding model and number of retrieved passages are missing, and only ratings are measured, not learning outcomes. Quality also drops as questions get harder, and the work covers English only.

3.2.8.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This research is relevant to the retrieval and answer-generation module of the proposed work, which also retrieves documents by similarity, passes them to an LLM and shows source references. While they personalize through the prompt, the proposed work changes the model's behavior with language and

depth adapters selected by LinUCB, learns from quiz-based rewards, and uses drift detection to correct misplaced learners. Its difficulty-level evaluation and its comparison of LLM only, retrieval only and the full system will guide the evaluation and ablation of the proposed work, which extends to English, Urdu and Urdish and to current affairs sources.

3.2.9 AI Driven Personalized Learning and Remedial Recommendation Through Knowledge Concept Centric Evaluation

A learning system that finds what a student doesn't know, makes practise questions with RAG and gives a proper study plan.

3.2.9.1 Summary of the research item

Pradeesh et al. [9] discusses how to identify what the student does not know and what to recommend in a course, with human assessment to maintain accuracy. First, the system reads the course PDF and retrieves the main concepts, then the teachers review them. They also choose how many easy, medium and hard questions to ask and what percentage does the student need to pass. Next, a model EKT reads the text of each question and checks whether the student's answer was right or wrong, then gives a score about how well the student knows each concept. If the concept score is below a certain target they are flagged as gaps. For each gap, the OpenAI model writes a five part study plan is reviewed by another model such as Gemini or Deepseek. Multiple-choice questions are generated with RAG from curriculum chunks, over-generated to about three times the number needed, filtered for duplicates by cosine similarity, and cross-verified for Bloom's level. Learners then take an adaptive test from Easy to Hard, and the results return to EKT. EKT was trained on 359,681 interactions from 1,276 graduated learners and reached a test AUC of 0.9334, slightly above DKT (0.9311). The question generator scored higher than MCQGen on semantic similarity to teacher questions (0.5642 against 0.3893). For 30 learners in a C programming course, mean concept scores rose after remediation, for example from 45.10 to 67.57, with $p < 0.0001$.

3.2.9.2 Critical analysis of the research item

One of the strengths of this research lies in connecting knowledge tracing, question generation, adaptive testing and remedial recommendation in one loop tested on real course data. It also filters generated questions in several steps, through over-generation, duplicate removal and a second-model check. However, there is no control group, only 30 learners were measured before and after, and the paper does not state that the two tests were matched in difficulty. Question quality is judged by similarity to teacher questions and by other LLMs, with a low relevance score of 1.56 out of 5. EKT's margin over DKT is

small, and the system was tested in one computer science program, in English, with paid APIs.

3.2.9.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This paper is related to the quiz generation module of our project and the tracking of how a learner is doing. It shows how to make multiple choice questions from real study material. It's checks will be used for our project's quizzes, make more questions than needed, remove repeated ones and have second model check them. The main difference is that their system changed what the learner should study next whereas our system changes how the topic is explained, which is done by changing the language and depth by an approach called LinUCB.

3.2.10 Multilingual Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Knowledge-Intensive Question Answering Task

A comparison of multilingual RAG strategies, and CrossRAG, which translates retrieved documents into English before answering in the question's language.

3.2.10.1 Summary of the research item

Ranaldi et al. [10] address how RAG should work when questions are not in English, since most earlier work assumes English questions and documents. They compare four pipelines: monolingual RAG, which retrieves in the question's language; tRAG, which translates the question into English first; MultiRAG, which retrieves across many languages; and CrossRAG, their proposal, which retrieves across languages, translates the retrieved documents into English and answers in the question's language. They tested GPT-4o, Llama-3-8B-Instruct and Command-R on MLQA, MKQA and XOR-TyDi QA, using a multilingual Wikipedia index, with the top five of 50 retrieved passages and Google Translate as the main translator. MultiRAG improved on monolingual RAG by 5.4 to 7.1 points, with larger gains for low-resource languages, while tRAG did worst because question translation could cause wrong retrieval. CrossRAG did better than MultiRAG. It scored about 2.5 to 3.4 points higher for common languages like English, and about 3.7 to 5.0 points higher for less common languages. It also gave more answers in the right language, and it kept working well even when the order of the documents was changed.

3.2.10.2 Critical analysis of the research item

One of the strength of this research is that it compares three benchmarks, three LLMs and both common and less common languages. It also checks the retreiver, the order of documents, and the language of the answer. Also the paper is peer reviewed but there are some weaknesses. The tasks are short questions taken from Wikipedia and a result is only considered correct if the right answer appears in output, so

long explanations are not covered. The languages do not include Urdu or Urdish text. The improvement over MultiRAG is only moderate, and CrossRAG needs an outside translator, which adds extra cost and makes it slower.

3.2.10.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This research is related to the retrieval part of Diplomind. Both face the same problem, as most of the evidence in Diplomind is in English but the user might ask questions in Urdu or Urdish. The authors warn that translating a question before searching can retrieve wrong passages. They also found that models work best with English, which is a good reason to keep the knowledge base in English. CrossRAG would apply if we added Urdu sources to the retrieval store. While they cover high- and low-resource languages in factual question answering, our work targets explanations in English, Urdu and Urdish at three depth levels, so we will test retrieval and answer language with Urdu and Urdish queries ourselves.

3.2.11 Personalized Learning Path Planning through Goal-Driven Learner State Modeling (Pxplore)

A reinforcement-learning framework that trains an LLM to plan personalized learning paths from a goal-based learner state and an automatically computed reward.

3.2.11.1 Summary of the research item

Lim et al. [11] present Pxplore, a framework that uses reinforcement learning to train an LLM to plan personalized learning paths. It keeps track of each learner through a state made up of long-term and short-term objectives and implicit and explicit motivations. After every learning action, an evaluator LLM updates this state from the learner's interactions, and the reward is the confidence-weighted number of goals that have newly become aligned. Training happens in two stages. The model is first finetuned on 300 real learning sessions, where GPT-4o generated the learner states and three human experts selected the best next action. Model is then further refined with GRPO [12] using the reward. When a learner is being served, the system builds a profile, retrieves 10 candidate lessons with a mix of keyword and semantic search, lets the trained model pick one, and has an LLM write a short bridge that links it to what the learner has just been doing.

After GRPO training, Qwen3-8B achieved a pedagogical alignment rate of 65.47%, outperforming GPT-4o (58.48%) when both were given the same state guidance. Separate evaluations by human and LLM judges also favoured the system for profile quality (+7.88% overall) and content delivery (+10.7%).The authors also ran a user study with 22 undergraduates, divided into two groups of 11. Students in the Pxplore group improved test scores from 61.81% to 90.09% (+28.28%).

3.2.11.2 Critical analysis of the research item

What this paper does best is that it turns vague learning goals into a reward that a model can actually be trained on. The two stage training is a good approach. The trained model beats a much larger proprietary one, and the authors test each part of the system (profiling, planning and delivery) separately, using both human raters and LLM judges.

The problems are mostly with the evidence. Only 300 sessions were used for training which is not much. The reward is also based on what an LLM thinks of a response and not on whether the learner actually understood. The user study is also limited with 22 students and a single lesson. Both groups had similar post test scores in the end so the benefit lies in how quickly the Pxplore group improved and how they felt about the experience. The platform and retrieval setup is built around Chinese language content so it is not clear whether the results would hold in other languages. It describes GRPO formulation loosely as it includes a value function that is not part of standard GRPO.

3.2.11.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

Pxplore is closer to slower batch trained module of DiploMind. We had planned the same two steps it uses, supervised finetuning followed by reward driven refinement. We explored GRPO [12] as a way to improve our adapters with reinforcement learning. This paper supports the idea that reward should track real gains in understanding not just engagement. It also shows that a model can be trained on recorded sessions with automatically computed reward, so there is no need to wait for live users. We use this paper as a guide for how this loop can be designed and not as a method to copy exactly. A real learner only gives one scored explanation per question but GRPO needs several scored answers for every prompt. With quiz based rewards it would be costly or hard to stabilize given our resources. So we may move to a simpler method instead. The main difference between our work and theirs is what is being optimised. Pxplore chooses the next piece of content, whereas DiploMind controls how content is delivered.

3.2.12 Corrective Retrieval Augmented Generation

A plug-and-play layer for retrieval-augmented generation that scores the retrieved documents, filters or discards them, and falls back to web search when retrieval is poor.

3.2.12.1 Summary of the research item

Yan et al. [13] address a weakness of retrieval-augmented generation (RAG): the quality of the answer depends heavily on the retrieved documents, and standard RAG has no way to notice when retrieval has

gone wrong, so irrelevant or misleading text is passed to the language model and can lead to hallucination. They propose Corrective Retrieval Augmented Generation (CRAG), a plug-and-play layer that can be added to an existing RAG system. The paper uses a small retrieval evaluator, which is a finetuned T5-large model, to judge how relevant each retrieved document is to the query. Depending on the score, the system takes one of three actions. If at least one document scores above an upper threshold, the retrieval is treated as Correct and the retrieved knowledge is kept and refined. If all documents score below a lower threshold, it is treated as Incorrect, the retrieved documents are discarded, and the system searches the web instead. Otherwise if the evaluator is not confident, the case is Ambiguous, and the refined retrieved knowledge is combined with web search results. Refinement is a decompose-then-recompose step: documents are split into short strips, the same evaluator scores each strip, and only the relevant strips are kept. For the web step, ChatGPT rewrites the query into keywords, the Google Search API returns the top five links, Wikipedia pages are preferred to reduce bias and unreliable sources, and the same refinement is applied to the pages.

CRAG was tested on four datasets covering short-form generation (PopQA), long-form generation (Biography, scored with FactScore), true-or-false questions (PubHealth) and multiple choice (Arc-Challenge), on top of both standard RAG and Self-RAG. Built on SelfRAG-LLaMA2-7b, it improved on standard RAG by 7.0% accuracy on PopQA, 14.9% FactScore on Biography, 36.6% accuracy on PubHealth and 15.4% accuracy on Arc-Challenge. The small T5-based evaluator judged retrieval quality better than ChatGPT, removing any one of the three actions reduced performance.

3.2.12.2 Critical analysis of the research item

The paper's strength is that it targets a common failure of RAG with a simple design, which is easy to attach to existing systems and is shown to help on two different base methods and four different tasks. The ablations show that each action contributes, the lightweight evaluator outperforms a much larger general model at the same judging task, and the "ambiguous" action is sensible when the evaluator is unsure. The weaknesses are mostly about scope. The evaluator has to be fine-tuned, which the authors acknowledge as a limitation and leave for future work. It was trained on data derived from PopQA and transferred to the other datasets, and the two thresholds were set empirically and differ between datasets, so how it would behave on other domains or languages is unknown. All the datasets are English factual or knowledge tasks, so the method has not been tested on explanatory writing, on Urdu, or on code-mixed text. It also depends on commercial services (a search API and ChatGPT for query rewriting), the web search step can bring in biased or unreliable pages, which the authors only partly address by preferring Wikipedia, and the reported compute overhead covers the generation stage and leaves out retrieval and fetching web pages.

3.2.12.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This paper is the main reference for the retrieval layer of DiploMind and for a possible web research extension. We plan to follow its approach of answering from the stored knowledge base first and only searching the web when retrieval fails. This costs less than searching the web on every request and it is easier to justify. It is also suitable as a knowledge base built from news articles can go out of date. We can use the retrieval evaluator for checking whether the stored articles actually answer a learner's question. The strip level refinement could also be useful when the source is a long document, for example if we add a feature that explains a document uploaded by the user. The paper's caution about unreliable web pages matters for us as well, because source quality is really important for political and IR content. The main difference is that, in DiploMind retrieving and correcting the evidence is only the first stage. The explanation is then personalised to the reader's preferred language and depth.

3.2.13 Cluster-Based Bandits: Fast Cold-Start for Recommender System New Users

A bandit method that places a new user in one of a fixed set of groups by asking a few questions chosen to best tell the groups apart.

3.2.13.1 Summary of the research item

Shams et al. [14] study how a recommender system can quickly learn the preferences of a new user with no history. A common approach clusters existing users into groups and trains a decision tree that maps a new user's ratings of a few items to a group, but users in the same group do not rate items identically, and this noise makes the tree unreliable (50 to 60 percent accuracy for some of 16 Netflix groups). The authors propose a cluster-based bandit in which the arms are groups, not items. The user is asked to rate a short sequence of items, chosen because they best distinguish groups. An item is a good distinguisher when the average ratings of two groups are far apart and the ratings within a group are consistent. The estimate of the user's group is updated after each rating. On Netflix, Jester and Goodreads data with 4 to 32 groups and simulated new users, it identified the correct group more often than an optimised decision tree (for example 0.91 against 0.75 with 16 groups on Netflix), with fewer than 10 ratings needed to separate 16 groups.

3.2.13.2 Critical analysis of the research item

The paper deals directly with noisy answers inside a group and gives a simple, interpretable measure for choosing the most useful questions. Its evidence is limited: it is a four-page paper, the new users are simulated from the groups' own statistics, the method needs per-group statistics from a large existing

user base, and all data are movie, joke and book ratings, with nothing on education. It places user in a group only once and later do not check if that placement was right.

3.2.13.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This paper is a useful reference for DiploMind's onboarding quiz module. It places each new user into one of the 9 groups based on predefined languages and depths. The paper's measure of how well a question separates groups can help us decide which questions to keep in our question bank. Its results also suggest that a short quiz of around ten questions is enough. Because DiploMind has no user base yet, the group statistics would come from a pilot study, IR experts or simulated learners. DiploMind differs in three ways. Our groups are fixed in advance by language and depth rather than discovered through clustering. Our questions test how comfortable the reader is with each language and how much they already know about IR. Finally, a reassignment mechanism later corrects any wrong placements.

3.2.14 PrepMate: An AI-Powered RAG System with News Summarization and Integrated Chatbot for Indian Languages

A RAG-based platform for civil-service exam aspirants that combines scraped news, a vector database, quiz generation and translation into Indian languages.

3.2.14.1 Summary of the research item

Joshi et al. [15] present PrepMate, a web platform that helps UPSC and MPSC civil-service aspirants keep up with current affairs. It scrapes articles from the Times of India and BBC News with BeautifulSoup, embeds them with a sentence-transformer model, and stores them in a ChromaDB vector database. A news chatbot retrieves the top three matching articles and passes them to Gemini to write an answer, and if nothing matches it scrapes the web again and retries. The platform also includes a document chatbot, a chatbot fine-tuned on 100 exam-style question-answer pairs, a generator of easy, medium or hard quiz questions from YouTube transcripts, and translation into five Indian languages. Evaluation is technical only, since the authors report no user study. They report 90% news retrieval relevance, 99% OCR accuracy, 90% accuracy for structured answers, and a translation BLEU score of about 41.0.

3.2.14.2 Critical analysis of the research item

The paper's strength is that it brings the practical pieces of a current-affairs learning tool into one working system, including a sensible fallback to fresh scraping when stored articles do not match. Its weaknesses are in the evidence. No users were tested, several accuracy figures are not defined, the BLEU score mainly measures the translation service, the fine-tuning set of 100 pairs is very small, and the

methodology and results disagree on which embedding model was used. It also depends on proprietary services, does not cover Urdu or code-mixed text, and does not personalise anything, since question difficulty is chosen by the user.

3.2.14.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This paper is a practical reference for the retrieval layer of DiploMind, which also grounds its explanations in scraped news stored in a vector database. PrepMate's fallback step, which scrapes fresh articles when nothing stored matches a query, is a precedent for a possible extension in which DiploMind searches the web when its knowledge base cannot answer a question. Its document chatbot, which answers questions from user-uploaded study material after OCR, is likewise a precedent for another possible extension, in which DiploMind explains a document supplied by the user. Its reporting gaps show that learner outcomes need defined metrics and real or validated simulated users. DiploMind differs in that it personalises both language and depth for each reader and learns from post-explanation quiz results.

3.2.15 Can Large Language Models Understand, Reason About, and Generate Code-Switched Text?

A benchmark and study of how well LLMs understand, reason over and produce code-switched text, including Urdu-English in both Urdu script and romanized form.

3.2.15.1 Summary of the research item

Winata et al. [16] study how well large language models work with code-switched text, meaning text in which two languages are mixed within a sentence. The study focuses on three abilities, which are understanding mixed text, reasoning over it and generating it. To test all this the authors created CodeMixQA, a dataset of roughly 64,000 questions, each rewritten into 16 language pair variants. Urdu-English is one of them and appears in both Urdu script and romanized form. To produce the mixed versions a single proprietary LLM was prompted in three different ways, called random switching, selective switching and grammar forcing. The amount of mixing is measured with the Code-Mixing Index (CMI), and native speakers rate each version for naturalness and accuracy on a five-point scale.

For Urdu-English, the choice of script mattered. Urdu-script versions were rated poorly for naturalness under every strategy (between 2.35 and 2.73 out of 5). Romanized versions scored 4.17 with selective switching and 4.12 with Urdu-grammar forcing . Accuracy was highest for romanized text built on Urdu grammar. Feedback on the Urdu outputs listed recurring problems: answering the question instead of rewriting it, leaving sentences in English, converting only part of the sentence, and mishandling Urdu

digits.

3.2.15.2 Critical analysis of the research item

The paper has several strengths. The prompts used for generation are published. The comparison of the three generation strategies is done side by side on the same question. To measure the amount of mixing CMI and Switch Point Fraction are used. Every strategy is ratted by native speakers against a written rubric. Also Urdu is covered in both scripts, and the its data and code are both open source.

Its limitations effect how much the findings can be applied. All the questions used as data are short and facts so we are not sure how this would work on long explanatory texts. Human ratings are done on small samples and many language pairs including Urdu have just one annotator. Mixed text generation is done from only English by using one proprietary model. Output is not used to finetune a any model so the outcome of training on this kind of data is not clear. This paper does not show if this training improves model's own mixing.

3.2.15.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This paper is used as a guide for how we build and check Urdish dataset for DiploMind. We plan to take scrapped Urdu and English news articles and make Urdish versions by using an LLM with few shot prompts. Then we will train our language adapters using these. According to this paper the prompts used for mixing effects the results. The most natural results were obtained by keeping Urdu grammar as base and inserting English words. We can design our Urdish prompts the same way. The paper also reports common mistakes LLMs make when mixing Urdu and English. We can turn these into checks and review criteria before these are used for training. This way we can validate the prompt outputs instead of blindly trusting it. Overall, the paper shows that the Urdish dataset should be created carefully and native speakers should review it before it is used.

3.2.16 Edu-Theater: A Data-Efficient Agent Framework for Scalable Learner Behavior Simulation through Staging Roll-Call

An LLM framework that simulates learners by first forming cohort-level proficiency priors and then refining each learner with a few targeted diagnostic queries.

3.2.16.1 Summary of the research item

Gao et al. [17] address the cost of simulating learners with LLMs. Existing simulators usually dedicate one agent to each learner and infer their knowledge from a long interaction history, which needs a lot of data and many model calls. The authors take a different approach, inspired by how a teacher analyzes

and understands a new class. Edu-Theater first groups learners into cohorts(groups) based on their past results, with one teacher agent holding each cohort's proficiency state. The teacher then refines each learner's state with a few targeted diagnostic queries over that learner's logged answers, and a learner who does not fit their cohort can be reviewed by other cohorts and moved. Finally, the teacher predicts the learner's answers to unseen questions. On two multiple-choice datasets (a university database course and high-school mathematics and physics, 500 learners each), it was the most accurate of the simulators compared, reaching 73.03% correctness accuracy against 71.30% for the strongest baseline, while using about 63 to 70% of the training data and costing less to run. Adding its simulated answers to the training data also improved an adaptive-testing model by 0.83 to 3.27 F1 points.

3.2.16.2 Critical analysis of the research item

This paper's methodology makes simulation cheaper and also less dependent on dense learner histories. It is compared against both supervised and LLM based simulators. However, its scope is narrow. The model only predicts if a learner will pick correct option in a multiple choice exercise. It also depends on replaying learner's own logged history. So, it cannot handle new learners who have no logs and it cannot predict learner's response to different styles of explanation. The evaluation covers two datasets one of which is not public. The improvements over best baseline is small. The paper is still a recent preprint.

3.2.16.3 Relationship to the proposed research work

This paper relates to Diplomind in three ways. First, it shows that LLM based simulated learners can work well even using little data. DiploMind needs this as before we have many real users, we have to test the bandit and the drift detection. We also need a way to score candidate explanations in the slower training loop. Simulated learners give us both. The second is the paper's onboarding method in which it starts from a cohort prior and then asks a few questions. DiploMind works in a very similar way. A new user takes an onboarding quiz, which places them in one of nine groups. Their later intermediate quiz results are used to adjust that placement. Third, its review and reassignment of learners who do not fit their cohort resembles DiploMind's reassignment of misplaced users. The main gap is what is simulated. Edu-Theater predicts answer correctness from past logs, whereas DiploMind would need a simulator that predicts how an explanation in a given language and depth affects understanding, so we would have to extend the idea and check it against real quiz data. DiploMind also defines its groups in advance from the quiz and does not find them by clustering.

3.3 Literature Review Summary Table

Table 3.1 gives a general overview of the papers that have been studied so far and their results.

Table 3.1: Literature Review Summary Table

Author	Method	Results	Limitations
Zhang et al. [1]	Training-free addition and negation of separately trained LoRA and $(IA)^3$ modules in weight space, tested on distribution generalization, multi-tasking, unlearning, and domain transfer	Gain of up to about 5 points on RTE from merging two LoRAs; GPT-2 toxicity score reduced from 0.10 to 0.01	Mostly small models; same architecture required; λ tuned manually; no language or style adapters
Huang et al. [2]	LoraHub: merges 20 randomly chosen LoRA modules, with weights tuned on about 5 examples using the gradient-free CMA-ES optimizer	Big-Bench Hard average of 34.7 vs 27.0 for zero-shot and 37.3 for in-context learning, using about 112 tokens per example vs 598	Below in-context learning on average; less stable with more modules; reasoning benchmarks only
Dinucu-Jianu et al. [3]	Online reinforcement learning (GRPO) of a 7B tutor LLM with a simulated student; reward combines post-dialogue solve rate and judged pedagogical quality	Student solve rate improved by 25.3 points vs 11.3 for the untrained model; solution leakage reduced from 29.3% to 10.6%	Simulated students only; math in English only; one policy for all students

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Table 3.1 – continued from previous page

Author	**Method**	**Results**	**Limitations**
Li et al. [4]	P-RLHF: a lightweight user model (individualized or cluster-based) is trained jointly with the LLM using Personalized DPO, tested on summarization, instruction following, and PRISM with 1,500 users	Accuracy on seen users 91% vs 59% for vanilla DPO; about 90% win rate on instruction following; above 60% win rate against vanilla DPO on PRISM	Simulated and GPT-judged preferences; needs offline pairwise feedback; no learning-outcome signal
Furqan et al. [5]	Hybrid dataset creation: synthetic English and Roman Urdu sentences generated with GPT-3.5, GPT-3.5 Turbo Instruct, and Claude Opus using few-shot, zero-shot, chain-of-thought, and topic-based prompts, combined with translated sentiment data and WhatsApp conversations, then corrected by human review	75,146 English and Roman Urdu sentence pairs; T5-Small reached 39.9 BLEU and mBART 38.8 BLEU when trained on it	Preprint; general-purpose data (stories, dialogues, daily sentences), not news articles; Roman Urdu only

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Table 3.1 – continued from previous page

Author	**Method**	**Results**	**Limitations**
Jang et al. [6]	Personalized Soups: trains one Tulu-7B policy per preference with PPO and LoRA, then merges matching policies by a weighted sum of parameters at inference.	Highest GPT-4 average win rate (55.23%); beat the untuned model 59.86% of the time. Human judges slightly preferred Prompted-MORL (58.70% vs 55.29%).	Fixed, user-declared preferences; GPT-4 simulated annotators; 24 human raters; 50 prompts, one 7B model, English; hand-set merge weights.
Li et al. [7]	LinUCB contextual bandit: ridge regression on user and article features plus an upper confidence bound (parameter α); offline replay evaluation.	User features raised click rates by around 10% over feature-free methods; beat ε-greedy, especially with scarce data (hybrid +10.3% at 1% of data).	Reward is clicks, not learning; linear payoff and fixed user interests assumed; α needs tuning; warm-start bias; one news service.
Liu et al. [8]	LPITutor: GPT-3.5 with RAG over course documents and a dual-layer prompt using learner information; answers cite sources.	Accuracy 97%, 94%, 89% (beginner to advanced). Factual accuracy 0.94 vs 0.88 (retrieval only) and 0.72 (LLM alone).	Personalization only via prompt and not evaluated separately; missing retrieval details; no learning outcomes; quality drops on harder questions; English only.

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Table 3.1 – continued from previous page

Author	**Method**	**Results**	**Limitations**
Pradeesh et al. [9]	Closed loop of knowledge tracing (EKT), RAG-based MCQ generation with filtering, cross-verified remedial plans, and adaptive testing.	EKT test AUC 0.9334 (DKT 0.9311); mean concept scores of 30 learners rose after remediation (e.g., 45.10 to 67.57, $p < 0.0001$).	No control group; only 30 learners; unmatched test difficulty not ruled out; question quality judged by similarity and LLMs; small margin over DKT; English only.
Ranaldi et al. [10]	CrossRAG: multilingual retrieval, retrieved documents translated to English, answer in the question's language; compared with monolingual RAG, tRAG and MultiRAG.	MultiRAG beat monolingual RAG by 5.4 to 7.1 points; CrossRAG gained a further 2.5 to 3.4 (high-resource) and 3.7 to 5.0 (low-resource) points.	Short factual Wikipedia questions only; Urdu and code-mixed text excluded; moderate gain; depends on an external translator.
Lim et al. [11]	Learner state model with an LLM-computed goal-alignment reward; fine-tuning on 300 sessions (14,584 turns), then GRPO; profiling, retrieval and narrative delivery modules	GRPO-trained Qwen3-8B reached 65.47% alignment vs 58.48% for GPT-4o with guidance; user study ($N = 22$): 61.81% to 90.09% post-test	Small dataset and user study ($N = 22$, one lesson); reward computed by an LLM; similar post-test scores in both groups; no control of language or explanation depth

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Table 3.1 – continued from previous page

Author	Method	Results	Limitations
Yan et al. [13]	Plug-and-play corrective layer for RAG: a fine-tuned T5-large retrieval evaluator triggers Correct, Incorrect or Ambiguous actions, with web search as a fallback and strip-level knowledge refinement	Over standard RAG (SelfRAG-LLaMA2-7b): +7.0% PopQA, +14.9% Biography FactScore, +36.6% PubHealth, +15.4% Arc-Challenge, Self-CRAG over Self-RAG: +6.9% PopQA, +5.0% Biography, +2.4% PubHealth, evaluator beats ChatGPT at judging retrieval	Needs a fine-tuned evaluator, English factual tasks only, relies on commercial search and ChatGPT, web pages may be unreliable, compute figures exclude retrieval
Shams et al. [14]	Cluster-based bandit: asks a new user to rate items chosen to best distinguish predefined groups, using an upper-confidence-bound rule and a stopping criterion; tested on Netflix, Jester and Goodreads with 4 to 32 groups	Higher group-identification accuracy than a decision tree (for example 0.91 vs 0.75 for 16 groups on Netflix) with similar regret and convergence time, under 10 ratings to separate 16 groups	Short paper, simulated new users, needs per-group statistics from an existing user base, fixed single-group membership, recommendation domains only, no check after placement

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Table 3.1 – continued from previous page

Author	**Method**	**Results**	**Limitations**
Joshi et al. [15]	RAG platform for civil-service aspirants: BeautifulSoup scraping, ChromaDB vector store, Gemini chatbots (one fine-tuned on 100 Q&A pairs), difficulty-based quiz generation, translation into five Indian languages	Reported 90% retrieval relevance, 99% OCR accuracy, 90% structured-answer accuracy, BLEU of about 41.0	No user study; undefined metrics; tiny fine-tuning set
Winata et al. [16]	Built CodeMixQA (about 64k questions in 16 language-pair variants); generated mixed text by prompting an LLM with random, selective and grammar-forcing strategies; tested 11 LLMs; native speakers rated naturalness and accuracy	Non-English grammar as base rated most natural (3.88 vs 2.99); Urdu-English romanized text reached 4.17 naturalness against at most 2.73 for Urdu script	Short factual questions; small human samples with one Urdu annotator; English source and one generator model; no fine-tuning on generated data
Gao et al. [17]	Cohort-aware LLM simulation: learners clustered into cohorts, a teacher agent per cohort refines each learner with a few retrospective diagnostic queries, with cohort reassignment; tested on DBE-KT22 and EduHS	Best simulation accuracy among compared simulators (73.03% vs 71.30% for Agent4Edu with full data); uses about 63–70% of the training data and lower cost; simulated data improved adaptive testing by 0.83 to 3.27 F1 points	Simulates only multiple-choice correctness from past logs; two datasets, one not yet released; modest gains over the strongest baseline; preprint

3.4 Conclusion

This chapter reviewed sixteen studies relevant to an adaptive multilingual learning platform for International Relations. The studies cover the composition of separately trained LoRA adapters, the personalization of language models to different users, the use of contextual bandits to choose between options, and the grounding of answers in retrieved evidence. They also cover the building of Roman Urdu and code-switched data, the profiling of new users, and tutoring and learner-simulation systems. Each of these techniques has been studied on its own, but most of the work is limited to English, relies on simulated users or fixed preferences, or uses rewards that do not measure whether a learner understood. None of the reviewed studies combines language and depth personalization for multilingual IR learners with correction of the learner's profile from comprehension results.

Chapter 4 Software Requirement Specifications

In this chapter, we describe the software requirements for DiploMind, covering both what the system should do and how well it should perform.

4.1 List of Features

Major features of our system are as follows.

- Let users sign up, create their accounts. Take a short onboarding quiz to build their profile.
- Automatically place each learner into one of nine groups (three language registers $\times$ three depth levels).
- Answer IR questions in English, Urdu or Urdish at easy, medium or technical depth.
- Give answers based on retrieved documents and provide reference to its source.
- After some explanations take short intermediate quizzes to check user understanding.
- Use a LinUCB contextual bandit for adaptive selection of language and depth adapters for each group.
- Detect when a learner's performance drifts and move them if they were placed in the wrong group.
- Update the shared adapters from time to time using quiz based rewards.

4.2 Functional Requirements

This section highlights the functional requirements of our system which relate to its technical functionalities. These requirements include:

- The system should allow a new learner to create an account with a name, email and password, and reject invalid input and duplicate email addresses.
- The system should collect profiling information (preferred language, English proficiency and prior IR background) through a short IR onboarding quiz during account creation.
- The system should assign the learner to one of the nine language $\times$ depth groups using the onboarding quiz results.
- The system should allow registered users to log in and log out.
- The system should allow the learner to submit an IR question as text.

- The system should retrieve relevant documents from the knowledge base for each question and generate the answer in the language register and depth of the adapter pair selected for the learner's group.
- The system should display source references with each answer, and inform the learner when no relevant documents are found instead of giving an unsupported answer.
- The system should store the chat history of each learner.
- The system should offer a short quiz after a few explanations, score the learner's answers and show the result.
- The system should use the quiz score as the reward for the adapter pair that produced the explanation, and store each quiz result together with the learner's group, the adapter pair used and the time.
- The system should monitor rewards within each group, flag learners whose performance deviates from their group, and reassign them to a more suitable group after analysing their chats and quiz results.
- The system should periodically update the shared adapters with the accumulated quiz-based rewards.
- The system should allow the learner to view their current group and their quiz scores over time.

4.3 Quality Attributes

Quality attributes are integral to the performance evaluation of a software system. They provide a checklist that aids in assessing the quality of the software. Following are the quality attributes of Diplomind:

- The system should provide answers similar to retrieved sources.
- The system should change the language and depth for each group according to the rewards.
- The system should be easy to use for learners without an IR or technical background.
- The system should be easy to modify and upgrade, with the base model, adapters, retrieval and data layers replaceable without changing the other parts.
- The system should protect learner profiles, chats and quiz results.
- The system should log every interaction so that adaptation can be analysed afterwards.

4.4 Non-Functional Requirements

This section describes all the non-functional requirements of our system, focusing on factors like performance (time, accuracy, errors), security, usability and extensibility.

- The system shall generate a personalized explanation, including retrieval and generation, within 20 seconds , so that the learner does not lose interest while waiting.
- The system shall respond to actions that do not need the language model, such as login, loading chats etc. in under 2 seconds.
- The system shall base every explanation on retrieved sources and inform the learner when none are found, minimizing factual errors.
- The system shall be efficient enough to detect a misplaced learner within a few quiz rounds and move them to a better-suited group in time, minimizing the number of unsuitable explanations they receive.
- The system shall display Urdu right-to-left, Urdish in Roman script and English left-to-right, so that each learner reads text in its natural form.
- Access controls shall restrict each learner to their own data, and uploaded documents shall be deleted after the session, ensuring privacy.
- The system should support modularity so that the adapters or other components such as base model, retriever or knowledge base can be swapped without affecting others.

4.5 Assumptions

Following assumptions are to be made during development:

- Users should have access to internet and latest web browser.
- Users can read at least one of the three language styles: English, Urdu, Urdish
- Details entered during signup may be inaccurate, so drift detection is added to catch the incorrect placement of user in groups.
- The university GPU server is available for hosting the model.
- The knowledge base is built from the validated public sources (Dawn, BBC World and ISSI).

4.6 Use Cases

This section describes the main use cases of DiploMind, covering how a learner registers, completes the onboarding quiz, asks questions, and receives personalized explanations. Each use case is given in tabular form with its actors, summary, pre-conditions, post-conditions, special requirements, and its basic and alternative flows. Table 4.1 to Table 4.8 list the use cases.

Table 4.1: Use case 1: User Registration

Name	User Registration
Actors	Learner
Summary	The learner creates a DiploMind account by providing a full name, an email address and a password. After successful validation, the system creates the account and an empty user profile, and takes the learner to the onboarding quiz.
Pre-Conditions	The learner does not already have an account with the email address being used.
Post-Conditions	A user account and an empty user profile (no language and depth group assigned yet) are stored. The learner is redirected to the onboarding quiz.
Special Requirements	Passwords must be stored as salted hashes and never as plain text. An email address can be registered only once. The password must be at least eight characters long.

Basic Flow			
Actor Action		**System Response**	
1	The learner opens the registration page.	2	The registration form is displayed asking for full name, email address, password and password confirmation.
3	The learner enters a full name, a valid email address, and a password with a matching confirmation, then submits the form.	4	The system validates the entries, creates the account and an empty user profile, and redirects the learner to the onboarding quiz.
Alternative Flow			
3-A	The learner enters an email address that is already registered.	4-A	The system responds with an error message: An account with this email address already exists.
3-B	The learner leaves a field empty or enters an invalid email address.	4-B	The system highlights the field and responds with an error message: Please fill in all fields with valid values.
3-C	The learner enters a password shorter than eight characters, or the confirmation does not match the password.	4-C	The system responds with an error message: The password must be at least eight characters long and match the confirmation.

Table 4.2: Use case 2: User Login

Name	User Login		
Actors	Learner		
Summary	The learner provides the registered email address and password. After successful verification, the system redirects the learner to the home page, or to the onboarding quiz if it has not been completed.		
Pre-Conditions	The learner has a registered account.		
Post-Conditions	The learner is redirected to the home page, or to the onboarding quiz if no language and depth group is stored in the user profile.		
Special Requirements	Passwords are verified against stored salted hashes.		
Basic Flow			
Actor Action		**System Response**	
1	The learner opens the login page.	2	The login page is displayed asking for email address and password.
3	The learner enters a valid email address and password, then submits the form.	4	The system verifies the credentials, establishes a session and redirects the learner to the home page.
Alternative Flow			
3-A	The learner enters an invalid email address or password.	4-A	The system responds with an error message: Incorrect email or password entered.
3-B	The learner leaves the email or password field empty.	4-B	The system highlights the empty field and responds with an error message: Please fill in all fields.
3-C	The learner enters valid credentials but has not completed the onboarding quiz.	4-C	The system establishes a session and redirects the learner to the onboarding quiz instead of the home page.

Table 4.3: Use case 3: Onboarding Quiz

Name	Onboarding Quiz		
Actors	Learner		
Summary	The learner answers a short diagnostic quiz that tests language comfort and background knowledge of IR. The system scores the answers, assigns the learner to a language and a depth level, stores them in the user profile, and takes the learner to the home page.		
Pre-Conditions	The learner is registered and logged in. No language and depth group is stored in the learner's profile. The quiz questions are available in the quiz bank.		
Post-Conditions	The learner's answers and scores are stored. A language and depth group is stored in the user profile. The learner is redirected to the home page and can ask questions.		
Special Requirements	Progress is saved after every answer so that the quiz can be resumed. Every question offers an "I am not sure" option.		
Basic Flow			
Actor Action		**System Response**	
1	The learner starts the onboarding quiz after registering or logging in.	2	The system displays brief instructions and the first question.

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Table 4.3 – continued from previous page

3	The learner selects an answer to each question in turn and selects Next.	4	The system records each answer and displays the next question until the last question has been answered.
5	The learner submits the answers.	6	The system scores the answers, assigns a language and a depth level, stores them in the user profile, and redirects the learner to the home page.
Alternative Flow			
3-A	The learner tries to continue without selecting an answer.	4-A	The system asks the learner to choose an answer or select “I am not sure”.
3-B	The learner leaves before finishing the quiz.	4-B	The system keeps the saved answers. When the learner next logs in, the quiz resumes at the first unanswered question.

Table 4.4: Use case 4: Ask Question and Receive a Personalized Explanation

Name	Ask Question and Receive a Personalized Explanation		
Actors	Learner		
Summary	The learner asks a question about an international relations topic. The system retrieves relevant articles and displays an explanation in the learner’s language and depth.		
Pre-Conditions	The learner is logged in. A language and depth group is stored in the learner’s profile. The knowledge base and the language model are available.		
Post-Conditions	The explanation is displayed together with its source articles. The question, retrieved articles, selected adapters and explanation are logged for the post-explanation quiz and later updates.		
Special Requirements	The explanation must be based on the retrieved articles.		
Basic Flow			
Actor Action		**System Response**	
1	The learner types a question about an IR topic and submits it.	2	The system displays a loading indicator, retrieves the most relevant articles, selects the adapters for the learner’s group, and displays the explanation with its sources.
Alternative Flow			
1-A	The learner submits an empty question.	2-A	The system asks the learner to type a question.
1-B	The learner submits a question while the language model is unavailable.	2-B	The system responds with an error message: The explanation could not be generated. Please try again.

Table 4.5: Use case 5: Take the Post-Explanation Quiz

Name	Take the Post-Explanation Quiz		
Actors	Learner		
Summary	After the learner has received a number of explanations, the system offers a short multiple-choice quiz on the topics discussed. The learner answers it and the result is recorded as feedback for the adaptation module.		
Pre-Conditions	The learner is logged in and there exists enough interaction log (5-10 prompts).		
Post-Conditions	The quiz score is displayed to the learner and stored as the reward signal for the learner's group.		
Special Requirements	Quiz questions are generated by the language model from the explained content and are not taken from a fixed question bank.		
Basic Flow			
Actor Action		**System Response**	
1	The learner continues asking questions in the chat.	2	After a number of explanations, the system offers a quiz on the topics discussed.
3	The learner accepts the quiz.	4	The system generates multiple-choice questions from the explained content and displays them in the chat.
5	The learner selects an answer for each question and submits the quiz.	6	The system evaluates the answers, displays the score with the correct answers and stores the result as the reward signal.
Alternative Flow			
3-A	The learner declines the quiz.	4-A	The system dismisses the quiz, records no reward and the chat continues.
3-B	The learner accepts the quiz while the model service is unavailable.	4-B	The system responds with an error message: Unable to generate the quiz. Please try again later.
5-A	The learner submits the quiz with unanswered questions.	6-A	The system highlights the unanswered questions and responds with an error message: Please answer all questions.

Table 4.6: Use case 6: Change Language Manually

Name	Change Language Manually
Actors	Learner
Summary	The learner selects English, Urdu or Urdish as the language of the explanations. The system updates the user profile and uses the selected language for all later explanations.
Pre-Conditions	The learner is logged in and has completed the onboarding quiz.
Post-Conditions	The selected language is stored in the user profile and applied to later explanations, while the depth level stays unchanged.
Special Requirements	The change takes effect from the next explanation without requiring the learner to log in again.

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Table 4.6 – continued from previous page

Basic Flow			
Actor Action		**System Response**	
1	The learner opens the language setting.	2	The system displays the available languages (English, Urdu and Urdish) with the current one highlighted.
3	The learner selects a different language.	4	The system updates the user profile, confirms the change and applies the selected language to later explanations.
Alternative Flow			
3-A	The learner selects the language already in use.	4-A	The system keeps the current language and makes no change to the profile.
3-B	The learner selects a language but the profile update fails.	4-B	The system keeps the previous language and responds with an error message: Unable to change the language. Please try again.

Table 4.7: Use case 7: Upload a Document and Receive an Explanation

Name	Upload a Document and Receive an Explanation		
Actors	Learner		
Summary	The learner uploads a document, such as an article or report, in the chat. The system extracts its text and explains its content in the learner's language and depth.		
Pre-Conditions	The learner is logged in and has completed the onboarding quiz. The document is in a supported format and within the size limit.		
Post-Conditions	The explanation of the document is displayed in the learner's language and depth, and the exchange is saved in the chat history.		
Special Requirements	The system accepts only supported file types and sizes, and the uploaded document is used only for the learner's own explanation.		
Basic Flow			
Actor Action		**System Response**	
1	The learner selects the upload option in the chat.	2	The system opens a file selection dialog.
3	The learner chooses a document and submits it.	4	The system validates the file and extracts its text.
5	The learner waits for the explanation.	6	The system selects the adapter pair for the learner's group, generates the explanation from the document content and displays it in the chat.
Alternative Flow			
3-A	The learner uploads a file in an unsupported format.	4-A	The system rejects the file and responds with an error message: This file type is not supported.
3-B	The learner uploads a file larger than the size limit.	4-B	The system rejects the file and responds with an error message: The file exceeds the allowed size.

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Table 4.7 – continued from previous page

3-C	The learner uploads a document from which no text can be extracted.	4-C	The system responds with an error message: No readable text was found in the document.

Table 4.8: Use case 8: Request Web Search on a Topic

Name	Request Web Search on a Topic		
Actors	Learner		
Summary	The learner asks the system to search the web for a topic that is not covered by the knowledge base. The system gathers information from web sources and explains it in the learner's language and depth.		
Pre-Conditions	The learner is logged in and has completed the onboarding quiz. The system has internet access.		
Post-Conditions	The explanation based on web sources is displayed with links to those sources, and the exchange is saved in the chat history.		
Special Requirements	Every web-based explanation must show the links of the sources used.		
Basic Flow			
Actor Action		**System Response**	
1	The learner enables the web search option in the chat.	2	The system confirms that web search is active for the next request.
3	The learner enters a topic and submits the request.	4	The system searches the web, retrieves the content of the relevant pages and extracts the useful text.
5	The learner waits for the explanation.	6	The system selects the adapter pair for the learner's group, generates the explanation and displays it with the source links.
Alternative Flow			
3-A	The learner submits the request with an empty topic.	4-A	The system responds with an error message: Please enter a topic.
3-B	The learner requests a topic for which no usable web results are found.	4-B	The system informs the learner that no relevant results were found and asks the learner to refine the topic.
3-C	The learner submits a request while the web search is unavailable.	4-C	The system responds with an error message: Web search is currently unavailable. Please try again later.

4.7 Hardware and Software Requirements

This section lists the hardware and software required to develop, train and run DiploMind.

4.7.1 Hardware Requirements

This section mentions the hardware needed for developing and running the system. These requirements are:

- A laptop or desktop with at least 16 GB RAM and a multi-core processor for development.
- A GPU with at least 16 GB VRAM for training the language and depth adapters and running the base model during demonstrations.
- Sufficient storage for model weights, the vector database and scraped articles.
- Any computer or mobile device with a modern web browser to use the interface.

4.7.2 Software Requirements

This section of the report highlights the software requirements for smooth development of the system. These include:

- Python
- Jupyter Notebook / Kaggle Notebooks
- FastAPI
- PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers and PEFT
- Llama-3-8B or Mistral-7B as the base language model
- BGE-M3 or Jina Embeddings v4 for multilingual embeddings
- A vector database and BM25 for retrieval
- A NoSQL database such as MongoDB
- Requests, BeautifulSoup and RSS feed parsers
- Tesseract OCR with Urdu support
- Git and GitHub
- Draw.io
- Chrome, Firefox or Edge

4.8 Graphical User Interface

This section presents the graphical user interface of each screen of the application, along with the functionality it provides and its intended users.

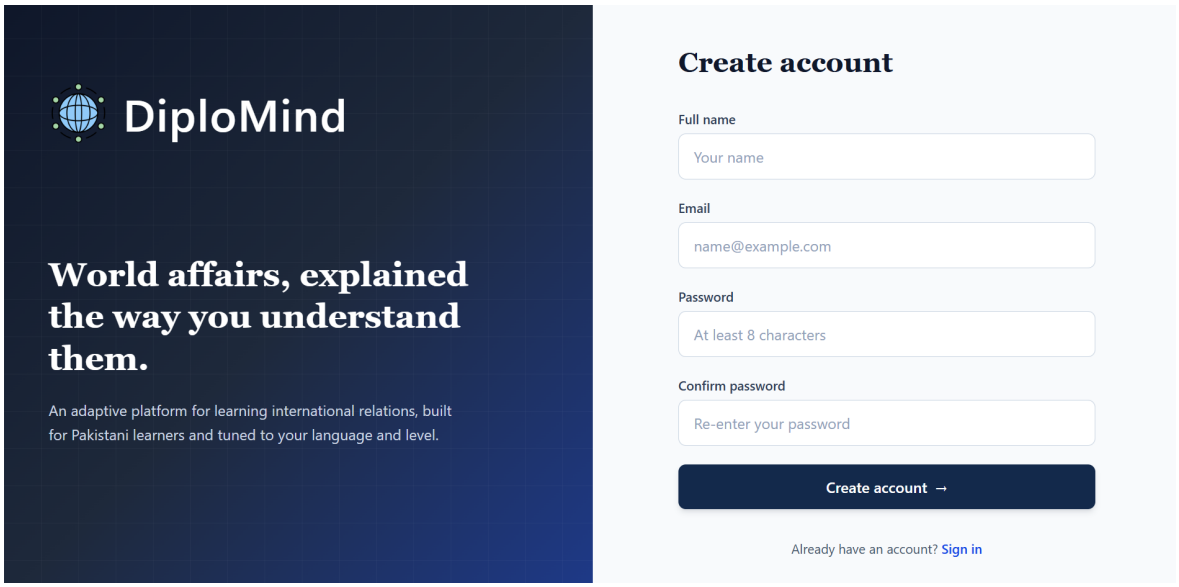


Figure 4.1: Sign-Up Screen

New users can create an account to get started

(Use Case 1: User Registration).

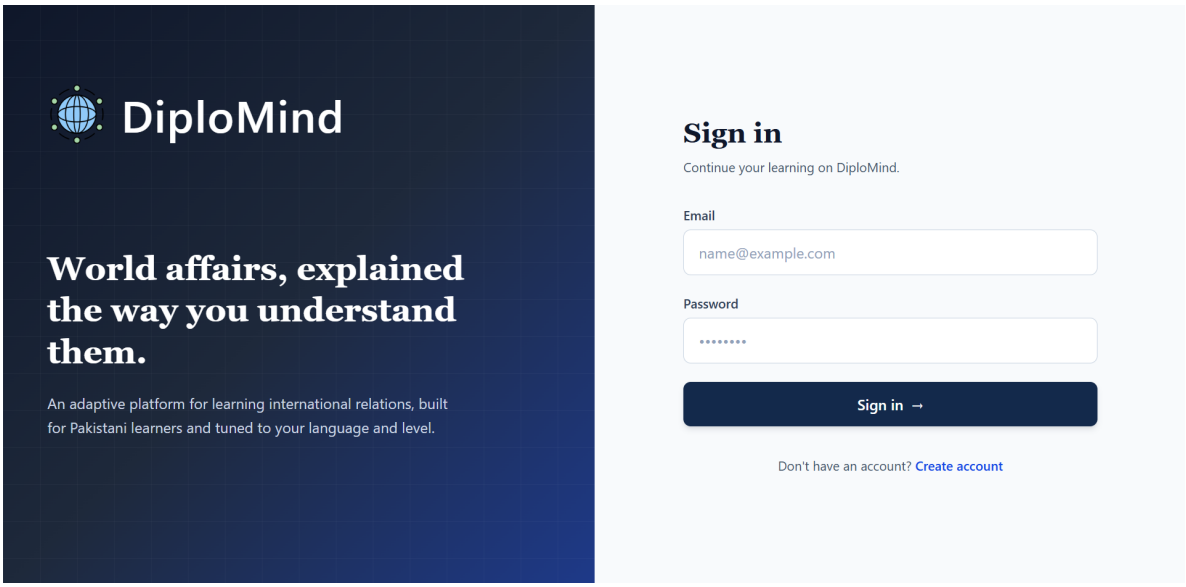


Figure 4.2: Sign-In Screen

Returning users can sign in to continue learning

(Use Case 2: User Login).

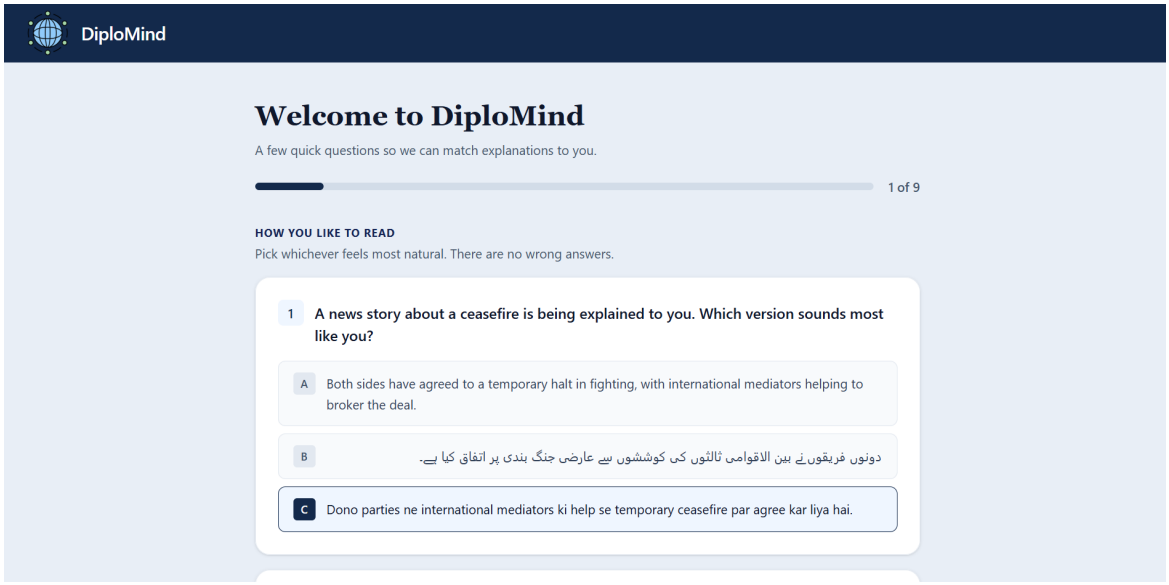


Figure 4.3: On-Boarding Quiz Screen No. 1

Users answer short questions so the system can gauge their level (Use Case 3: Onboarding Quiz).

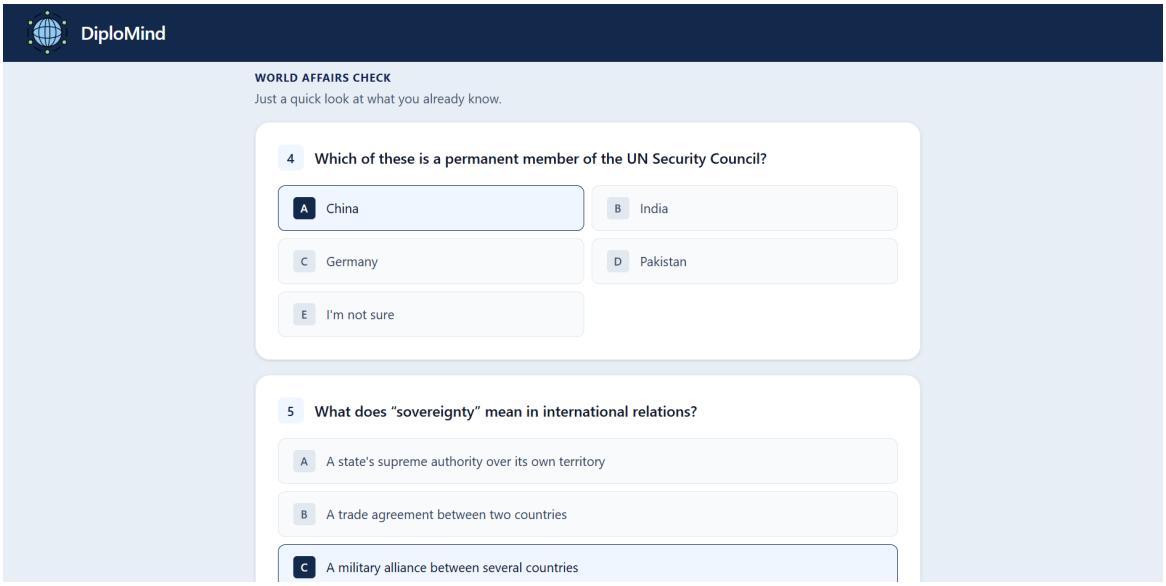


Figure 4.4: On-Boarding Quiz Screen No. 2

Users answer short questions so the system can gauge their level (Use Case 3: Onboarding Quiz).

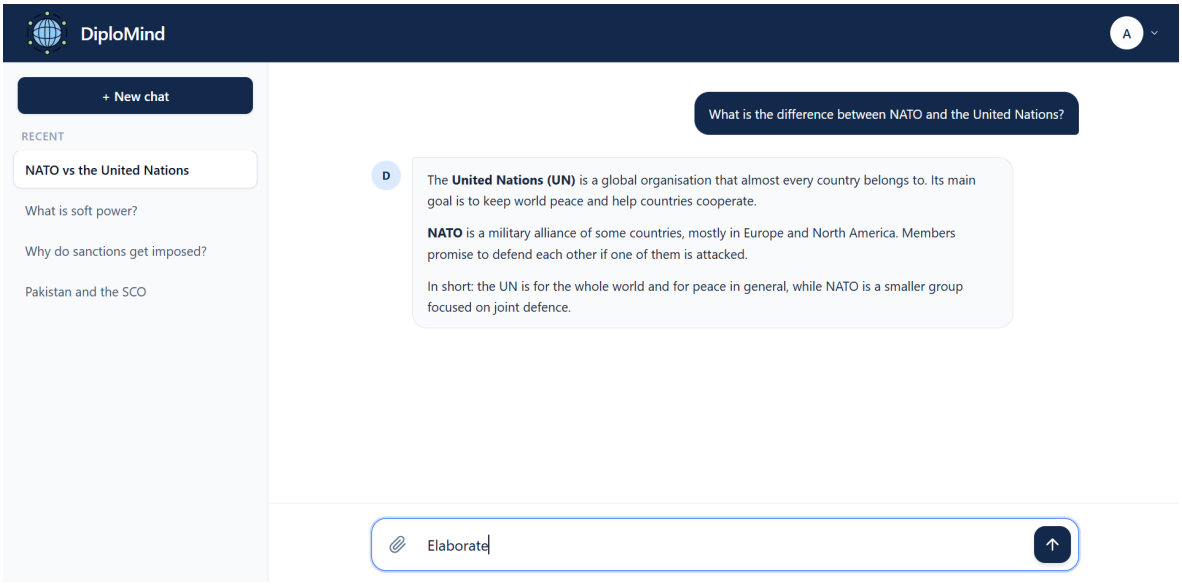


Figure 4.5: Chatbot Screen

Users ask questions and get answers matched to their language and level (Use Case 4: Ask Question and Receive a Personalized Explanation).

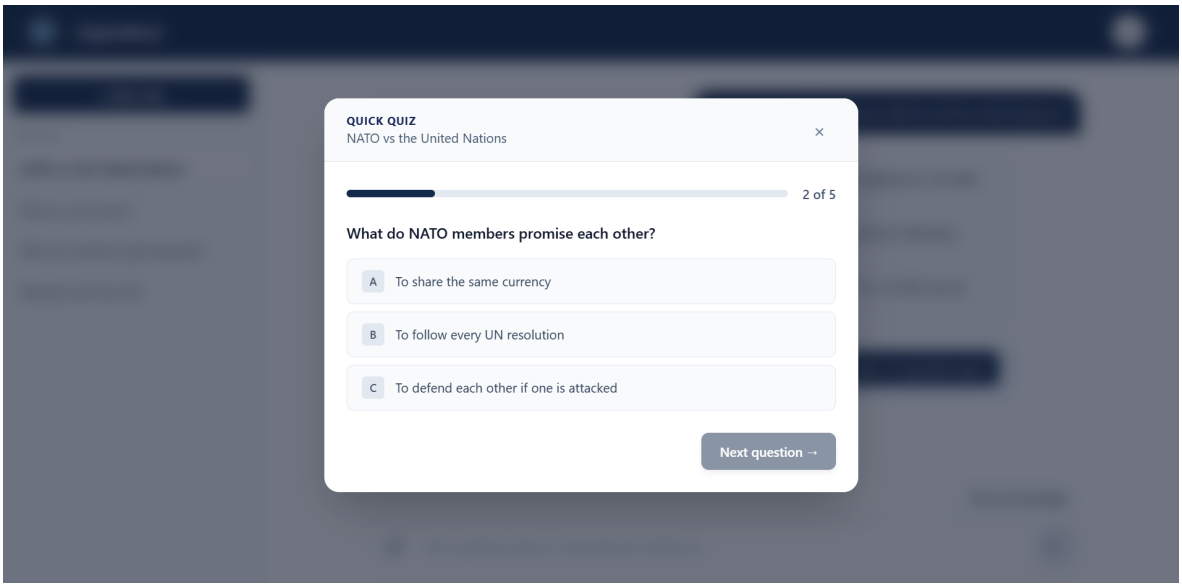


Figure 4.6: Post-Explanation Quiz Popup

After a few questions, a short quiz appears in the chat to check the user's understanding (Use Case 5: Take the Post-Explanation Quiz).

4.9 Database Design

DiploMind stores its data in MongoDB, a NoSQL document database. Instead of tables with fixed columns and enforced relationships, the data is kept as collections of flexible, JSON-like documents. An Entity Relationship Diagram (ERD) is designed for relational databases, where tables are linked through enforced foreign keys, so it does not fit our design. Instead we use a data dictionary , shown below. For each collection, it lists the fields, their data types and for reference fields, which collection they point to. A field marked (FK) stores the ID of a document from another collection. MongoDB does not enforce these links, so our application is responsible for keeping them consistent.

4.9.1 Data Dictionary

Table 4.9: Data Dictionary: Article

Entity	Attribute	Data Type	Relation To	Nullable	Description
Article	ArticleID	String		No	Unique ID of the article (PK)
	Source	String		No	Where the article was scraped from (Dawn, BBC World, ISSI)
	ContentType	String		No	Either current_affairs or foundational
	Title	String		No	Headline of the article
	Link	String		No	URL of the article page
	PdfUrl	String		Yes	PDF link, only for PDF-based sources
	ScrapedAt	Date		No	Date and time the article was scraped
	Text	String		No	Full extracted text of the article
	PublishedAt	Date		Yes	Original publication date of the article
	Language	String		No	Language of the text (en or ur)

Table 4.10: Data Dictionary: User

Entity	Attribute	Data Type	Relation To	Nullable	Description
User	UserID	ObjectId		No	Unique ID of the user (PK)
	Name	String		No	Full name of the user
	Email	String		No	Login email of the user, must be unique
	PasswordHash	String		No	Hashed password of the user
	Register	String		No	Preferred language: english, urdu or urdish
	Depth	String		No	Knowledge level: easy, medium or hard
	Onboarding Completed	Boolean		No	Whether the onboarding quiz is finished
	CreatedAt	Date		No	Account creation time
	LastLogin	Date		Yes	Time of the last login

Table 4.11: Data Dictionary: Conversation

Entity	Attribute	Data Type	Relation To	Nullable	Description
Conversation	ConversationID	ObjectId		No	Unique ID of the chat session (PK)
	UserID	ObjectId	User	No	Owner of the chat (FK)
	Title	String		No	Title shown in the chat history sidebar
	CreatedAt	Date		No	When the chat started
	UpdatedAt	Date		No	Time of the last message

Table 4.12: Data Dictionary: Message

Entity	Attribute	Data Type	Relation To	Nullable	Description
Message	MessageID	ObjectId		No	Unique ID of the message (PK)
	ConversationID	ObjectId	Conversation	No	Chat the message belongs to (FK)
	Role	String		No	Sender of the message: user or assistant
	Content	String		No	Text of the message
	AdapterPair	Object		Yes	Language and depth adapter used (assistant messages only)
	SourceArticleIDs	Array of String	Article	Yes	Articles used to answer (FK list)
	CreatedAt	Date		No	Time the message was sent

Table 4.13: Data Dictionary: Onboarding Quiz Question Bank

Entity	Attribute	Data Type	Relation To	Nullable	Description
Quiz Question	QuestionID	ObjectId		No	Unique ID of the question (PK)
	Question	String		No	Question text
	Options	Array of String		No	Answer choices
	CorrectAnswer	String		No	The correct option, must be one of Options
	Topic	String		Yes	IR topic the question covers
	Difficulty	String		No	easy, medium or hard
	Language	String		No	Language of the question

Table 4.14: Data Dictionary: User Onboarding Response

Entity	Attribute	Data Type	Relation To	Nullable	Description
Onboarding Response	ResponseID	ObjectId		No	Unique ID of the response (PK)
	UserID	ObjectId	User	No	User who answered (FK)
	QuestionID	ObjectId	Quiz Question	No	Bank question that was answered (FK)
	SelectedAnswer	String		No	Option the user picked
	IsCorrect	Boolean		No	Whether the answer was right
	AnsweredAt	Date		No	Time the question was answered

Table 4.15: Data Dictionary: Intermediate Quiz Response

Entity	Attribute	Data Type	Relation To	Nullable	Description
Intermediate Quiz Response	ResponseID	ObjectId		No	Unique ID of the response (PK)
	UserID	ObjectId	User	No	User who answered (FK)
	ConversationID	ObjectId	Conversation	No	Chat the quiz appeared in (FK)
	QuestionText	String		No	Question generated by the LLM
	Options	Array of String		No	Answer choices of the generated question
	CorrectAnswer	String		No	Correct option of the generated question
	SelectedAnswer	String		No	Option the user picked
	IsCorrect	Boolean		No	Whether the answer was right
	Reward	Number		No	Reward value calculated from the answer
	AnsweredAt	Date		No	Time the question was answered

4.10 Risk Analysis

This section highlights the main risks that may affect the development, maintenance and scalability of our system

4.10.1 Technical Risks

DiploMind relies on fast moving technologies like large language models, LoRA adapters and vector databases. The tools and models we use today may change in future. The base model may need to be replaced by a newer one, which would require the adapters to be trained again, and the libraries and APIs we use may become obsolete and have to be replaced. The scraping pipeline depends on external news websites, so a change in a website's layout can break it. The adapters are trained on LLM-generated and translated Urdu and Urdish text, so mistakes in this data can reach the final answers if it is not reviewed. Updating the model from quiz feedback using the GRPO approach is hard to implement, as it needs a well-designed reward, a lot of compute, and enough user data, so it may have to be replaced by a simpler method.

4.10.2 Business Risks

If the language model is to be hosted on a GPU server or in cloud, then running the application can be expensive and funding may be required. Developers and subject experts will also be required to maintain the application. As, the knowledge base is built from news and research websites, their terms of copyright may limit to how we use the content. Also, user profiles are to be stored too, so protecting user privacy is essential because a data leak can damage people's trust.

4.11 Conclusion

This chapter focused on what Diplomind is required to do. It covers functional, quality and non-functional requirements alongwith assumptions. This chapter also describes the use cases about what the learner can do through the application. The GUI screens show the flow of the application. The data dictionary defines the data stored in the system and the technical and business risks are also discussed, that may affect the system. Together all these requirements are the base for the methodology and design of the system.

Chapter 5 Proposed Approach and Methodology

This chapter explains how DiploMind works and how we plan to develop it. We start with how we collect and prepare the data. Next we explain how language and depth adapters are trained and combined. After that we cover how a new learner is placed into a group at start, how the system retrieves evidence and choose an adapter pair for user request. Then how learner feedback is used as a reward and how the system corrects itself over time. The main idea is that explanation is personalized along two independent axes. One is the language it is written in (English, Urdu or Urdish) and other is its depth (easy, medium or technical).

5.1 Overview of the Proposed Approach

The approach has four stages, shown in Figure 5.1.

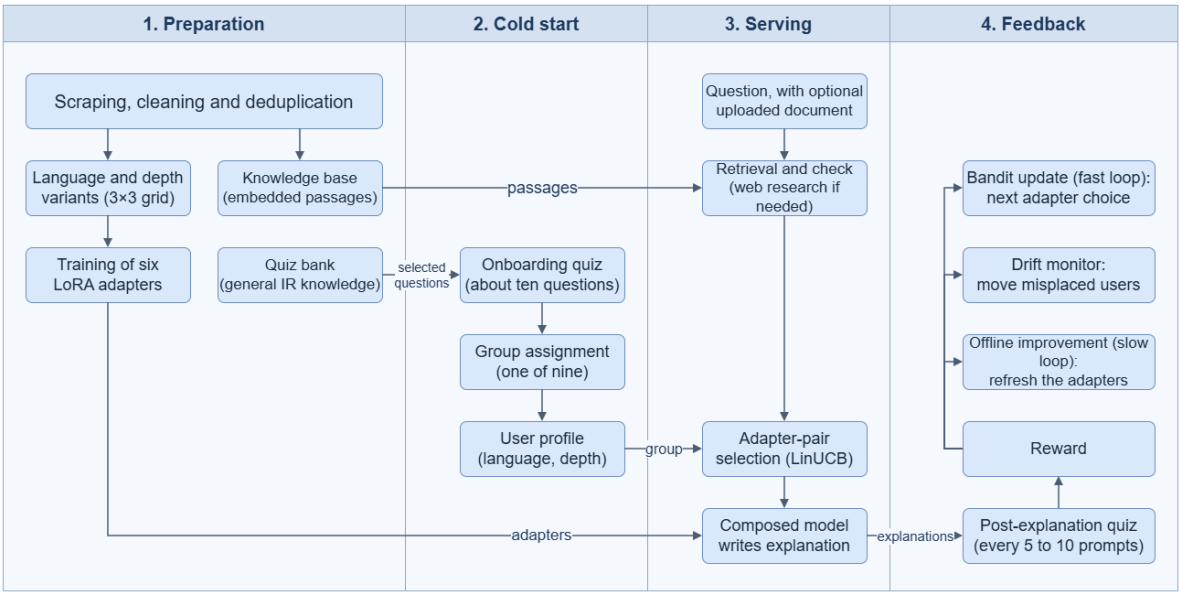


Figure 5.1: Overview of the four stages of the proposed approach

1. **Offline preparation.** News and international relations (IR) articles are collected and cleaned, a knowledge base is built, and the training data for the language and depth adapters and the quiz bank are prepared.
2. **Cold start.** A short onboarding quiz places each new user into one of nine groups (three languages times three depths), which gives a sensible starting point before anything is known about the user.
3. **Online serving.** When a learner asks a question the system retrieves a relevant article and checks it. A bandit then chooses which adapter pair to use and those two adapters are merged. The

merged model writes the explanation which is then formatted and displayed to user. Learners can also upload a document, or ask for web research.

4. **Feedback and improvement.** Once the learner has read some explanations they take a short quiz, and the quiz score becomes a reward. This reward is used in three ways. First, it updates the bandit immediately so it makes a better adapter choice next time (the fast loop). Second, drift monitor uses it to spot learners who were placed in the wrong group and moves them to a better one that better suits them. It is also saved, so the adapters themselves can be improved later in batches (the slow loop).

Keeping the two loops separate is deliberate. Choosing between existing adapter pairs is cheap and can happen after every quiz, whereas changing the adapters themselves is expensive and needs many results, so it is done in batches.

5.2 Data Collection and Dataset Construction

5.2.1 Source Selection and Scraping

The sources are Pakistani and international news and analysis outlets that publish in English and Urdu, together with foundational explainers on international relations. For every article the scraper stores the title, body text, publication date, URL, outlet and language. We use site-specific scrapers or RSS feeds. Paywalled content is excluded, and article text is used for research only and is not redistributed. So far we have built scraping pipelines and collected articles from the sources in Table 5.1.

Table 5.1: Sources used for Data Scrapping

Source	Language	Content
BBC News	English	International and current-affairs news
BBC News Urdu	Urdu	International and current-affairs news in Urdu
Dawn	English	Pakistani newspaper
Express	*U*rdu	Pakistani newspaper
Geo	*U*rdu	Pakistani news channel and website
ISSI	English	Analysis from the Institute of Strategic Studies Islamabad

5.2.2 Cleaning, Filtering and Deduplication

Raw pages contain much that is not article text, so the collected articles pass through the following steps.

1. Boilerplate such as menus, advertisements and related-article lists is removed.

2. Pages that are not news or analysis are discarded.

3. A topic filter keeps only international relations and current-affairs content, using a keyword list followed by a classifier.

The publication date is kept throughout, because the knowledge base needs it to prefer recent articles for current-affairs questions.

5.2.3 Knowledge Base Construction

Each cleaned article is split into passages of a few hundred tokens with a small overlap, so that a sentence cut at a boundary still appears whole in one of the passages. Every passage is turned into a vector with a multilingual embedding model and stored in a vector database together with its metadata (outlet, date, language and URL). We plan to compare BGE-M3 and Jina Embeddings v4, among others, as embedding models. Articles stay in their original language, and because the embedding model is multilingual, an English question can retrieve an Urdu passage and the reverse. Multilingual retrieval-augmented generation for knowledge-intensive question answering has been studied by Ranaldi et al. [10]. New articles are added by a scheduled ingestion job, and older articles can be down-weighted or archived.

5.2.4 Building the Language Variants (English, Urdu, Urdish)

The adapters need aligned examples of the same content in each language. We take Urdu passages and use an LLM with few-shot prompts to produce an English version and an Urdish version of each. This follows the idea of LLM-generated parallel data with human correction, as used to build a Roman Urdu parallel dataset [5].

The Urdish prompts are designed around the findings of Winata et al. [16]: keeping Urdu grammar as the base and inserting English words where Pakistani speakers naturally use them gave the most natural results. In IR terms this mostly means technical and institutional terms like sanctions, summit and veto. Each prompt includes a few hand checked examples and instructions to preserve names, numbers, dates and facts. As Winata et al. found that readers rated Roman script more natural for Urdu-English text so we write Urdish in Roman script. Before the generated text is used for training, native speakers review samples of it, and batches that fail the review are regenerated with improved prompts.

5.2.5 Building the Depth Variants (Easy, Medium, Technical)

Depth is defined by a short rubric (Table 5.2) so that the three levels can be told apart. For adapter training a few source passages are rewritten at every level by an LLM using the rubric and a few-shot example per level.

Table 5.2: Rubric for the three depth levels

Level	Vocabulary and jargon	Sentences and context	Assumed background
Easy	Everyday words; jargon avoided or explained in the sentence	Short sentences; a concrete example or analogy	None
Medium	Some standard IR terms, each with a short definition	Moderate length; brief context about the actors and events	Some familiarity with current events
Technical	Field terminology used without explanation	Longer analytic sentences; references to institutions, treaties or theories	Working knowledge of IR

5.2.6 Training Pairs and Splits

For every source passage the pipeline produces a grid of nine aligned versions (three languages times three depths), shown in Figure 5.2. The training pairs are drawn from this grid so that each adapter learns one axis only.

- **Language adapter pairs:** a source passage with a language instruction, paired with the version in that language. The depth of the target is varied evenly across easy, medium and technical, so the adapter does not pick up a hidden depth preference.
- **Depth adapter pairs:** a source passage with a depth instruction, paired with the version at that depth. The language is varied evenly across the three languages.

Splits are made by article, not by passage, so that no article appears in both the training and the validation or test data. A fixed set of test passages is held out for the whole project.

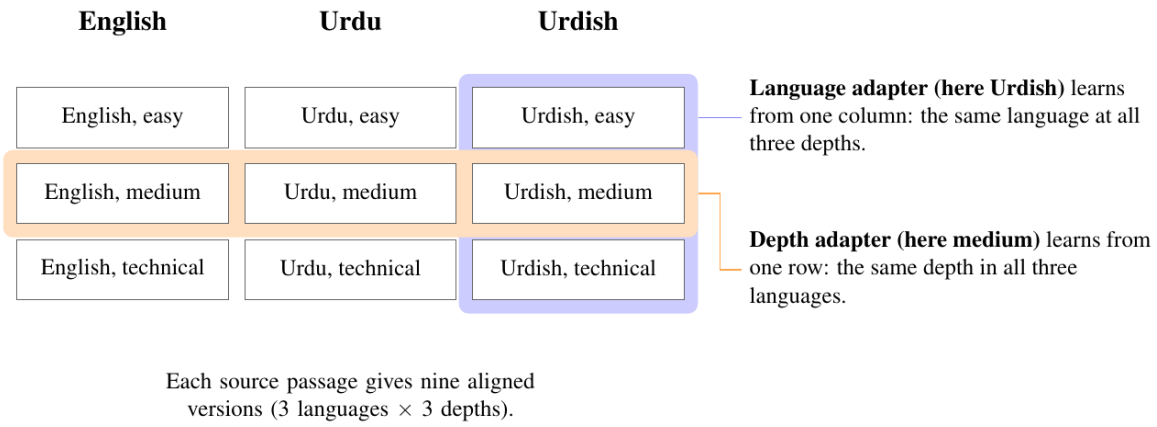


Figure 5.2: The 3×3 grid of aligned versions of one source passage, and how the six training sets are drawn from it.

5.3 Adapter Training and Composition

5.3.1 Training

Six adapters are trained: three language adapters and three depth adapters. We use low-rank adaptation (LoRA), which keeps the base language model frozen and trains only small low-rank matrices added to its weights, so each adapter is small and cheap to train and store. Training is supervised fine-tuning with the loss computed on the response tokens only, with the instruction masked. The base model candidates are LLaMA-3-8B and Mistral-7B. Starting settings to tune are a learning rate between 10^{-4} and 3×10^{-4}, two to four epochs, and early stopping on a validation set.

5.3.2 Composition

For a user in group (language l, depth d), the model used at inference is the base model plus a weighted sum of the two adapters' low-rank updates:

$$W = W_0 + \lambda_L \Delta W_{\text{lang}}(l) + \lambda_D \Delta W_{\text{depth}}(d), \tag{5.1}$$

We set λ_L and λ_D with a grid search, we try a range of values and keep the pair that does best on a validation set. This follows the arithmetic composition of parameter-efficient modules by Zhang et al. [1] and the weighted composition of LoRA modules in LoraHub [2], and it is related to the merging of separately trained modules for different preferences in Personalized Soups [6]. Other work selects adapters per query using task embeddings [18]; in contrast, our choice of pair is driven by user feedback.

Composition gives nine behaviours from six adapters, which avoids training nine joint adapters. One risk is that the two updates can interfere with each other. To check for this, we can also train nine adapters one for each group, and compare the composed model against them.

5.4 Onboarding Quiz and Group Assignment

A new user has no history, so the system starts with a short onboarding quiz and uses the answers to place the user in one of the nine groups (three languages times three depths). The placement only needs to be a good starting point, because the drift later corrects users who were placed in the wrong group.

5.4.1 Question Design

The quiz has two parts, one for each axis: language comfort, and background knowledge of international relations. In the language part, the learner tells which style of text they find easiest to read. In the

knowledge part, the learner answers questions about common terms (for example *sanctions* or *ceasefire*) and well-known events, in order of increasing difficulty. Every question has an "I am not sure" option.

What matters most is that the questions separate the groups. Learners in the same group should give similar answers to a question, and learners in different groups should give clearly different answers on average. A question that everyone answers in the same way tells us nothing about where to place a learner, and a question that learners in the same group answer very differently is too unreliable to be useful. We therefore review the draft questions and replace those that are ambiguous or that nearly everyone answers alike. This idea comes from the cluster-based bandit of Shams et al. [14], which prefers questions whose answers differ strongly between groups and stay consistent within a group, and we use it here as a guideline for writing and selecting questions. We will get these onboarding quiz question bank reviewed by IR experts.

5.4.2 Scoring and Group Assignment

For each axis, there will be fixed rules to score answers. For language selection, the user is asked to select which sentence they find easiest to read and understand and based on that they are assigned the language. For depth selection, the user is asked IR knowledge questions in their assigned language. Based on their correct answers they are assigned one of the three knowledge groups using fixed cut off points. A user who gives few correct answers is assigned easy group, the one who answers most correctly is assigned technical and those in between are assigned medium. If user skips a questions or marks it not sure it is counted as incorrect.

By combining the results of both of these type of questions, the user is assigned one of the nine groups. This is saved in the user profile and based on this the starting arm of the bandit is selected. If answering and scoring is not completed user is placed in a default group i.e., Urdish and medium depth.

5.4.3 Adaptive Question Selection

Extending the above idea, we can build an advanced version of onboarding quiz questions selection. In this version it selects the next question to ask user on the runtime based on how well it separates the groups. It stops as soon as one group is clearly ahead. This requires the average answers for questions for every group for which we plan to get outputs of IR experts and conduct a pilot study of users.

5.5 Retrieval and Grounded Generation

GAs in many retrieval based tutoring systems like LPITutor [8], if we generate explanations based on retrieved text it keeps it tied to real articles instead of model's memory. The weakness of this idea is that

an explanation is only as good as the passages it is given. If the passages retrieved are out of date or off topic the model can write a response that sounds fluent but is wrong. To overcome this issue we plan to use the idea of corrective retrieval augmented generation (CRAG) [13]. In this, the retrieved article is checked before being used. The system's next action depends on the quality of retrieval. Figure 5.3 shows the three stages: retrieval, knowledge correction and generation. The structure is adapted from the corrective approach of Yan et al. [13].

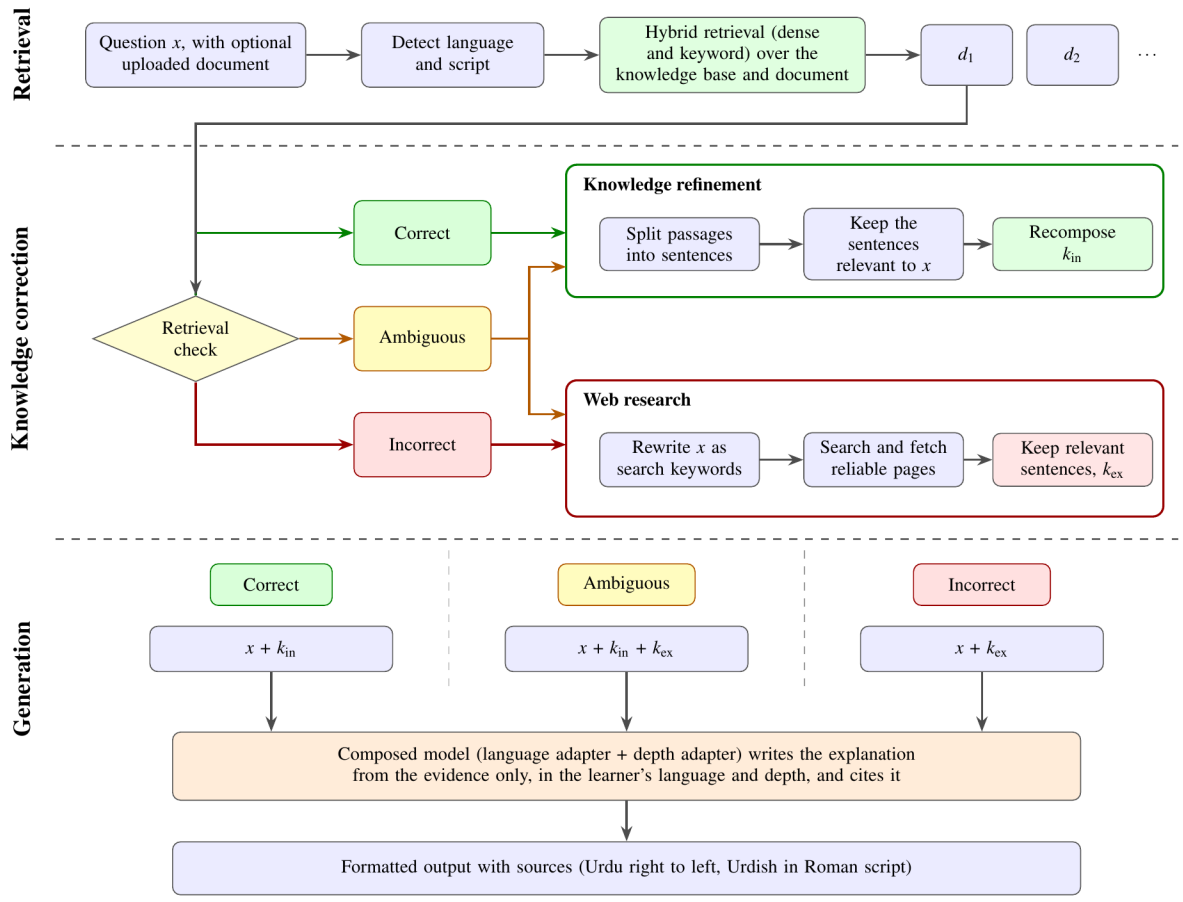


Figure 5.3: Processing of one request in DiploMind: retrieval, knowledge correction and grounded generation.

5.5.1 Retrieval

When a question arrives, the system first detects its language and script. It then searches the knowledge base. Dense vector search, which matches meaning, is combined with keyword search, which matches exact terms such as names and places, through a weighted score

$$s(p) = \beta\, s_{\text{dense}}(p) + (1-\beta)\, s_{\text{keyword}}(p), \tag{5.2}$$

as in Pxplore [11]. For current-affairs questions, a recency filter or boost favours newer articles. The best-scoring passages are passed to the next stage.

5.5.2 Retrieval Check and Knowledge Correction

A passage can look similar to a question without actually answering it, so the retrieval is checked before the evidence is used. Yan et al. make this check with a small fine-tuned model. We have no labelled data to train such a model, so we begin with a simpler version based on the retrieval scores and two thresholds. If at least one passage scores above the upper threshold, the retrieval is judged *correct*. If every passage scores below the lower threshold, it is judged *incorrect*. Anything in between is *ambiguous*. The thresholds are tuned on a small set of questions labelled by the team. Each outcome triggers a different action.

- **Correct:** the stored passages are kept and refined.
- **Incorrect:** the stored passages are discarded, and the system turns to web research instead.
- **Ambiguous:** the system does both and combines the results.

Knowledge refinement. Even relevant passages can have sentences that are not relevent and helpful. Each passage is therefore split into sentences, each sentence is scored against the question with the same similarity measure, and only the relevant sentences are kept, in their original order. The result, written k_{in}, is a short and focused piece of evidence.

Web research. When the stored articles cannot answer the question, it is rewritten as a few search keywords, the web is searched, and the top pages are fetched, with reliable outlets preferred. The sentence-level filtering is also applied to the retrieved data and the result is written as k_{ex}.

5.5.3 Generation

The composed model, which combines the language and depth adapters chosen for the user, receives the question together with the evidence that matches the outcome: k_{in} when retrieval was correct, k_{in} and k_{ex} when it was ambiguous, and k_{ex} when it was incorrect. It is instructed to rely only on this evidence, to write in the learner's language and depth, and to cite its sources. If no usable evidence is found even after web research, the system says that it could not find reliable information instead of guessing. Finally, the output is formatted: Urdu text is displayed right to left, Urdish is shown in Roman script, and the sources are attached.

5.6 Adaptive Adapter Selection with LinUCB

The nine language-depth combinations are the arms of a contextual bandit, and the user's group gives the starting arm. A contextual bandit learns which option works best in which situation by trying options and observing the reward, while balancing the use of what looks best against trying alternatives that are less certain. We use the LinUCB approach of Li et al. [7], which scores each arm by its estimated reward given the user's context plus a bonus for arms about which it is uncertain. We apply it as described in that paper and do not repeat its derivation here.

The context describes the user and the request, for example the group, the onboarding scores, the recent average reward, the language of the query and the number of earlier interactions. The final feature list will be fixed during implementation.

Three design choices adapt the bandit to learning:

- **Safe exploration.** The bandit may only choose between the user's current arm and its neighbours, meaning the same language with one depth step up or down, or the same depth with another language. This stops it from showing a technical explanation to an easy-level user as an experiment. The exploration parameter is kept small at first.
- **A warm start.** Each arm starts from the group assigned by the onboarding quiz and not from zero knowledge, and the statistics are shared by users in the same group.
- **One choice per quiz window.** Because the reward arrives only after the post-explanation quiz, the arm is chosen at the start of each window of five to ten prompts and kept for that window, so the reward can be attributed to a single arm.

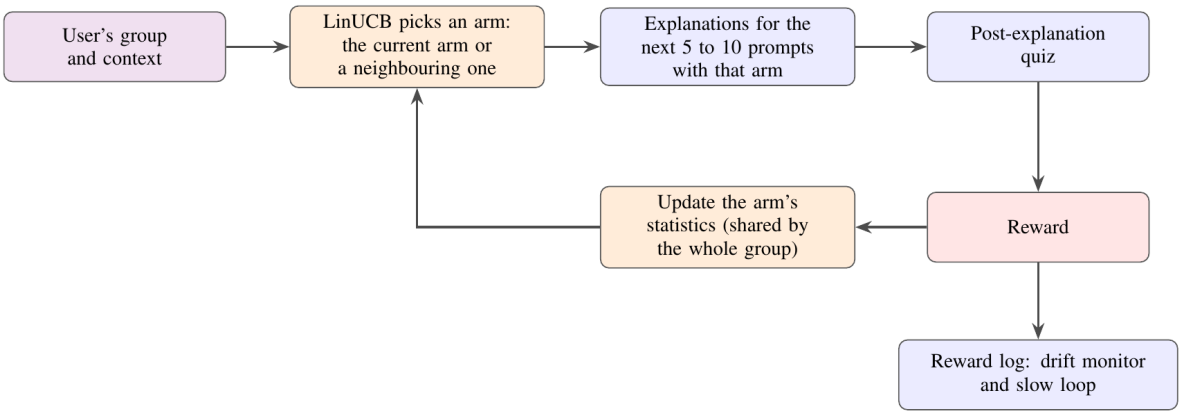


Figure 5.4: The fast loop: the bandit chooses an adapter pair, the learner's quiz result becomes a reward, and the reward updates the bandit.

5.7 Reward Design and the Post-Explanation Quiz

5.7.1 Quiz Generation

After every five to ten prompts from the user, the LLM generates three to five multiple-choice questions from the recent explanations. Along with each question, it gives the correct answer, the sentence from the explanations that supports it, and a difficulty level (easy, medium or hard). Each question gets a difficulty weight d_q of 1, 2 or 3 based on its level, so that a correct answer to a harder question counts for more.

5.7.2 Reward

To calculate the reward we look at two things, one is how well the user understood the explanations. The other is how well it came out in the language and style they asked for.

$$r = \text{clip}\left(w_s s + w_m m - w_p p,\ 0,\ 1\right) \tag{5.3}$$

where:

- $s = \sum_q d_q c_q \big/ \sum_q d_q$ is the difficulty-weighted quiz score, where $c_q = 1$ if question q is answered correctly and 0 otherwise;
- m is a score from automatic checks of whether the explanation is in the correct language and script and, for Urdish, uses a natural mix of Urdu and English words;
- p is a penalty for statements not supported by the sources, the wrong script, or an overly long explanation.

The weights w_s, w_m and w_p are tuned later. Manual language changes by the user are also logged, since they suggest that the user may be in the wrong group.

A quiz score depends not only on the explanation but also on the user's background and on how hard the questions are, so it is a noisy signal. Weighting questions by difficulty and comparing each user's rewards with those of their own group help reduce this noise.

5.8 Drift Detection and Group Reassignment

The onboarding quiz can place a user in the wrong group, for example if the user overstated their English, and a user's needs can also change over time. The drift monitor (Figure 5.5) detects such cases and corrects them by comparing how each user is doing with how the rest of their group is doing.

For every group, the system keeps the mean and standard deviation of the rewards of its users. For every user, it keeps a rolling mean of their last W quiz rewards (for example $W = 3$), so that a single bad quiz does not trigger a change. A user is flagged as an outlier if this rolling mean is below the group mean by more than k standard deviations, or if the user repeatedly overrides the assigned language or depth, which is a direct sign that the placement does not suit them.

For a flagged user, the system estimates the expected reward under each neighbouring group, using the bandit's learned model and, if needed, by trying that group for a while. The user is moved only if a neighbouring group's estimate exceeds the current group's by a margin δ, which prevents small or noisy differences from causing a move. After any reassignment, a cool-down period applies so that a user is not moved back and forth, and every event is logged.

The values of W, k, δ and the cool-down are tuned in simulation. A similar idea of reviewing a learner against other cohorts and reassigning them appears in Edu-Theater [17]. A bandit that gradually discounts old data, so that it adapts when preferences change, is a possible extension that we leave to future work.

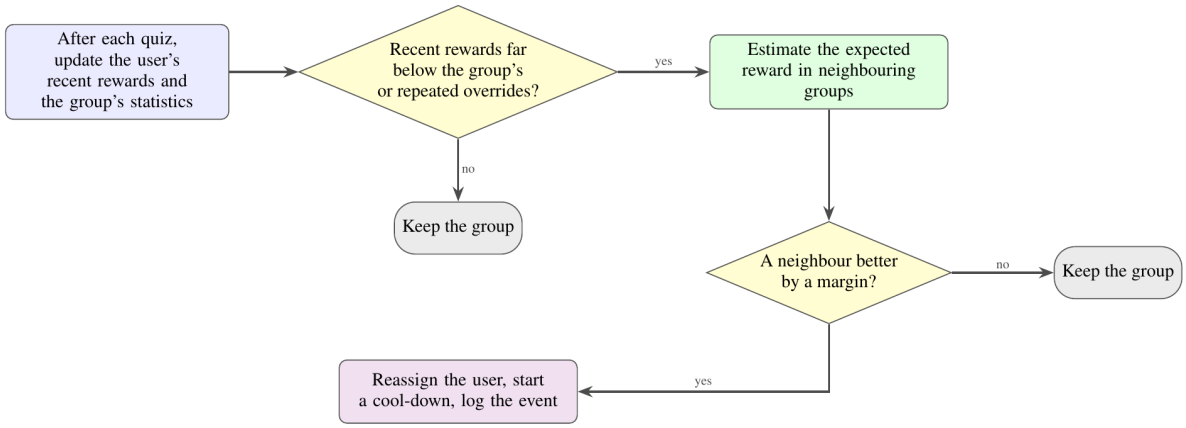


Figure 5.5: Flow of the drift monitor that detects and corrects misplaced users.

5.9 Offline Improvement Loop (Slow Loop)

The slow loop is meant to improve the shared language and depth adapters from accumulated results. A real user sees only one explanation per prompt, so the user's quiz result cannot be used to score other possible explanations of the same prompt. For this reason, the loop works offline. Logged prompts are taken from the system, the current model writes several candidate explanations for each, and the candidates are scored using automatic checks together with an estimate of how well a learner would understand them. This estimate can come from a reward model or from a simulated learner, an LLM

that plays a learner of the given group, reads the explanation and answers the quiz, an idea also used to train a tutoring model against simulated students by Dinucu-Jianu et al. [3]. Because LLM judges can be unreliable in Urdu, any simulated learner has to be checked against real quiz results and native speakers before it is trusted.

The scores are then used to update the six shared adapters, so that every group benefits. The choice on how this update will be done will be made during implementation. We have not yet fixed, and we expect to try the options in order of difficulty. The simplest is to keep the best-scoring candidate for each prompt and train on it with ordinary supervised fine-tuning. A second option is to train on pairs of a better and a worse candidate, so that the better one becomes more likely. The most demanding option is Group Relative Policy Optimization (GRPO) [12], which compares each candidate with the others written for the same prompt and makes above-average candidates more likely, as Pxplore does after supervised fine-tuning [11]. We explored GRPO, but it needs several scored candidates per prompt and a reliable reward, so we may switch to the simpler options depending on our time and results.

No matter which option we end up using, the updated adapters don't replace the current ones right away. We first test them on a test set and get some of their outputs reviewed by native speakers. We also keep the older versions, so if a new adapter does worse we can roll back to the previous one.

5.10 Conclusion

This chapter described the proposed methodology of DiploMind. A data pipeline builds a knowledge base and aligned language and depth variants of news content, and six LoRA adapters are trained and com bined by weighted addition. Initially, users are placed in one of the nine groups using a short onboarding quiz. Neighboring adapter pairs are tested using contextual bandit using quiz based rewards and drift monitor corrects the wrongly placed learners. The adapters are improved over time using an offline loop. The explanations presented to the users are based on retrieved evidence which can also include web search and document upload. Several choices are yet to be made like the base model selection, type of slow loop optimization and the tuning of quiz and reward. These will be decided based on experimental results.

Chapter 6 High-Level and Low-Level Design

This chapter focuses at design level of DiploMind. It includes overview of the system and factors such as assumptions,constraints and goals. It also dicusses the system architecture and the design diagrams. At last, it also defines the policies and tactics which are to be followed.

Together, these sections explain how the system works and how it can be maintained and extended in the future.

6.1 System Overview

DiploMind is a web-based adaptive learning platform that explains international relations (IR) and current-affairs topics to Pakistani readers in the language and depth that suit them. The users of the system are learners, who can create an account, take a short onboarding quiz, ask IR questions in a chat, upload a document to have it explained, ask the system to search the web for a topic, and change their explanation language. Each learner is placed into one of nine groups formed by three languages (English, Urdu and Urdish) and three depth levels, and every explanation is generated from articles in the system's knowledge base and shown with its sources. After every few explanations, a short quiz checks the learner's understanding, and its result is used to keep adjusting the explanations given to that learner.

6.1.1 DiploMind Modules

DiploMind achieves personalized and continuously corrected explanations through five modules that work together. The design of each module is discussed in the following subsections.

6.1.1.1 Data Scraping Module

This module collects current affairs and foundational IR content from news and think tank sources such as Dawn, BBC World and ISSI. In this module, we clean these articles by removing extra unwanted content such as menus, ads, etc. Only the articles focusing on IR and current affairs are kept which are tagged by language and content type. Next, the article is divided into small passages which are turned into embeddings through a multilingual embedding model and then stored in vector database. This allows the questions asked in one language to be answered in other languages.

6.1.1.2 Cold-Start Profiling Module

The users who have no history are handled by cold start profiling. The users have to give a short onboarding quiz when they join so that the system can know about their language preference and their

IR background. Every question has an ”I am not sure” option so nobody is forced to answer. These answers are used to put the users into one of the nine groups which is then used for the explanation generation.

6.1.1.3 Content Adaptation Module

This module works on explanation generation. The system pulls the most relevant passages from the knowledge base, then checks that they actually answer the question. A LinUCB contextual bandit then selects a language adapter and a depth adapter for the learner, and the two LoRA adapters are combined on a shared base language model to generate an explanation that uses only the retrieved passages and cites them. The same module explains uploaded documents and web search results when the learner requests them.

6.1.1.4 Feedback and Reward Module

This module checks whether the explanations were actually understood. After every 5–10 questions, it generates a short multiple-choice quiz from the recent explanations and scores the learner’s answers. The quiz score is the reward for adapter pair that produces explanations to improve them overtime. The reward is also used for updating bandit immediately.

6.1.1.5 Drift Detection Module

This module checks whether a learner’s group is still correct over time. It compares the learner’s recent quiz rewards with the average rewards of their group, and flags learners who perform much worse than their group or who repeatedly change the assigned language. A flagged learner is moved to a neighbouring group if that group is expected to suit them better, with a cool-down period after each move so that the learner is not switched back and forth.

6.2 Design Considerations

This section addresses the critical aspects that shape the foundation of the design process for DiploMind.

6.2.1 Assumptions and Dependencies

This section describes the assumptions and dependencies that shape the design and functionality of DiploMind.

6.2.1.1 Assumptions

- Learners have a modern web browser and an internet connection.
- Learners can read at least one of the three languages offered: English, Urdu or Urdish.
- The information given by learners during onboarding may not be accurate, which is why drift detection is part of the design.
- The selected news and think-tank sources remain publicly accessible and allow their content to be used for research.
- Separately trained language and depth adapters can be combined without one cancelling the effect of the other.
- A learner's quiz score reflects how well they understood the explanations they received, so it can be used as a reward.
- The group statistics needed for the onboarding quiz can be obtained from a pilot study, expert estimates or simulated learners, since the system starts without users.

6.2.1.2 Dependencies

- The system depends on an open instruction-tuned base language model, such as Llama-3-8B or Mistral-7B, and on PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers and PEFT to train and combine its adapters. Replacing the base model requires the adapters to be trained again.
- Retrieval relies on two things, a multilingual embedding model, like BGE-M3 or Jina Embeddings v4, and a vector database that stores the passages and searches through them.
- The knowledge base depends on the scraping pipeline and on the structure of the source websites. A change in a website's layout can break its scraper.
- The web search feature depends on an external search service and an internet connection.
- Explaining scanned documents depends on Tesseract OCR with Urdu language support.
- The quality of the Urdu and Urdish training data depends on review by native speakers.
- Training the adapters and running the model depend on the availability of a GPU with at least 16 GB of memory.

6.2.2 General Constraints

The design of DiploMind is shaped by the following constraints, each of which has a significant effect on the system.

6.2.2.1 Hardware Constraints

The system is not hosted on a server and runs on a single GPU with about 16 GB of memory, either on a local machine or on Kaggle. This limits the size of the base model and the number of learners that can be served at the same time, and is one of the main reasons for using small adapters on a single shared model instead of a separate model for each group.

6.2.2.2 Data Availability

There is no existing dataset of IR content written in English, Urdu and Urdish at different depths. The training data for the adapters therefore has to be generated with a language model and then reviewed by native speakers, which takes time and limits the size of the dataset. Urdish also has no standard spelling, which makes its quality harder to check.

6.2.2.3 Source Availability

The knowledge base is made from scraping other websites, those websites can block access at any time. They can also limit what can be done with their content, so we leave out anything behind a paywall and use the scraped articles for research only.

6.2.2.4 Performance Requirements

The system should give an explanation in about 20 seconds and handle other actions like logging in or loading chats, within 2 seconds. These time limits decide how many passages we can re-rank and how long the explanations can be.

6.2.2.5 Security and Privacy

Each user should only access their own data. Any document a user uploads should be deleted when the session ends and should not be added to knowledge base. Password should also not be saved as plain text but as salted hashes.

6.2.2.6 Language and Script

Urdu must be displayed right-to-left, Urdish in Roman script and English left-to-right. Extracting text from scanned Urdu documents is also difficult, which limits the quality of explanations for such documents.

6.2.3 Goals and Guidelines

The goals and guidelines followed in the design and development of DiploMind are discussed below.

6.2.3.1 Simplicity

Following the KISS principle ("Keep it simple, stupid!"), each component starts with the simplest method that can work and is made more complex only if needed. For example, a fixed-rule scoring of the onboarding quiz is kept as an alternative to the adaptive quiz, and the adapters are first improved with the simplest training option before more advanced methods are tried.

6.2.3.2 Grounded and Reliable Answers

IR is political and changes fast, so it is not enough for an explanation to be easy to read, it should also point to a source. If a reliable source is not found the user is told.

6.2.3.3 Safe Personalization

The system should never show a learner an explanation far from their level just to experiment. The bandit is only allowed to try neighbouring adapter pairs, and a learner who is moved to another group cannot be moved again until a cool-down period has passed.

6.2.3.4 Modularity

The technologies we use in this project change continuously, so the base model, adapters, retreiver, database and bandit are kept as separate modules. They can be changed without changing others.

6.2.3.5 User-Centric Design

The interface is designed to feel like the chat assistants that learners already use, so that it is familiar and needs no instructions. Computationally expensive work, such as scraping new articles and improving the adapters, runs in the background so that it does not slow down the learner.

6.2.4 Development Methods

The software design and development of DiploMind follows an agile and iterative approach. DiploMind has 2 phases, research and development. During the development the system is built in increments. We thought of waterfall model but did not select it because of the research parts, such as how to combine the adapters and how to design the reward signal as these may have uncertain outcomes.

6.3 System Architecture

This part shows the architecture of system through high level diagrams. It also discusses the responsibilities of subsystems. Diplomind has mainly 2 parts: the offline preparation and the online learning part. The offline preparation part collects and prepares data for knowledge base and adapter training. The second part is actually what the user uses. When a new user arrives he is placed into a group. For every question, it retrieves the content and generates an explanation according to user profile. The adapters are also trained by the quiz results. The web interface talks to the backend through API requests and the backend keeps its data in a NoSQL database and vector database. The high-level architecture of the system is shown in Figure 6.1.

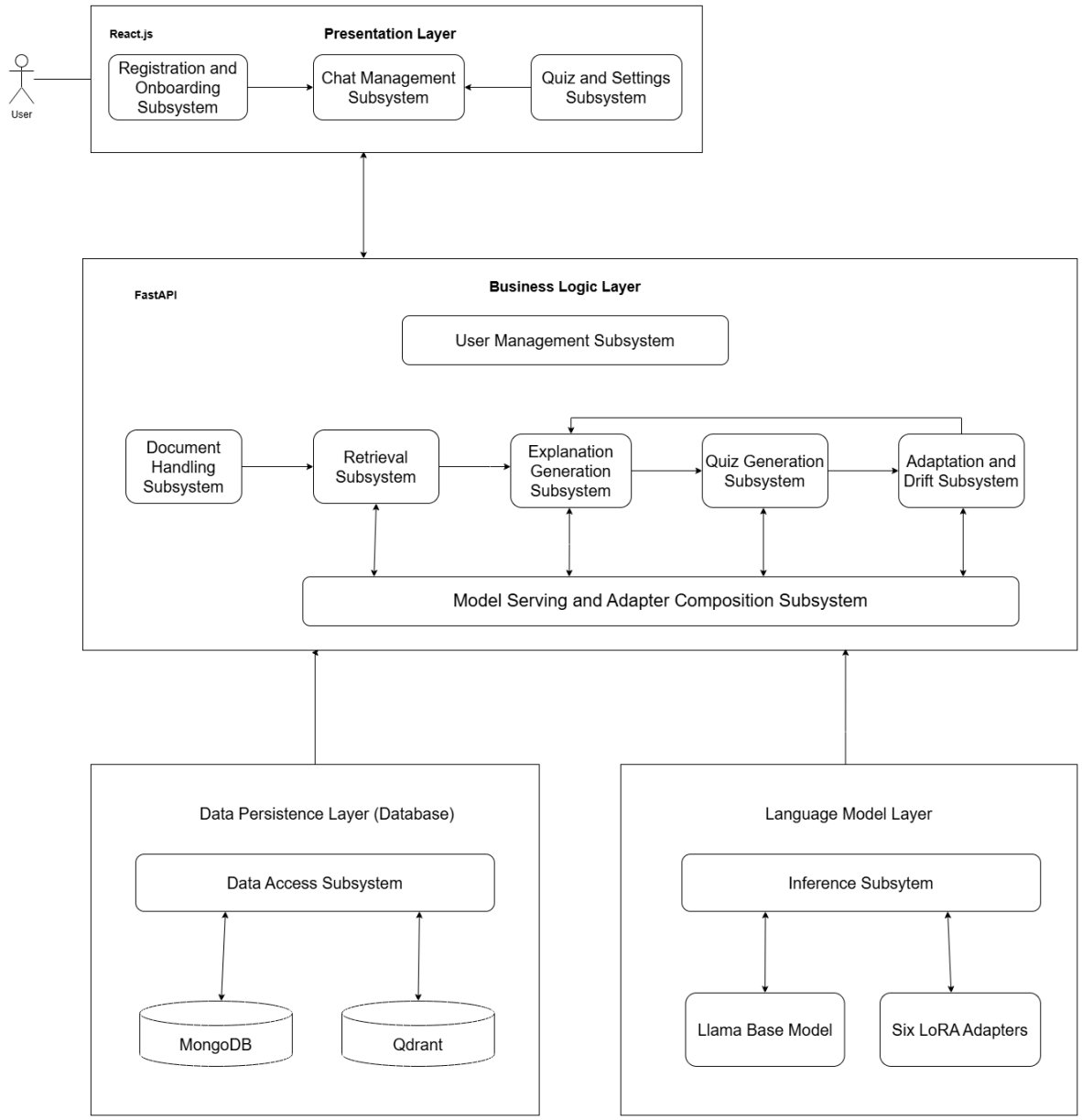


Figure 6.1: High-level Architecture Diagram

This is the high-level architecture diagram of DiploMind.

6.3.1 Data Scraping and Knowledge Base

The Data Scraping subsystem acquires the content used to answer learners' questions. It consists of three components: the scraper, the preprocessor and the indexer. The scraper uses site-specific scrapers and RSS feeds to fetch articles, storing the title, text, publication date, link, source and language of each article. The preprocessor removes boilerplate content, checks the language, filters out content that is not related to IR or current affairs, and tags each article as current affairs or foundational. The indexer splits each article into passages, embeds them with the multilingual embedding model and stores them in the

vector database, while the full article is stored in the NoSQL database. The structure of this subsystem is shown in Figure 6.2.

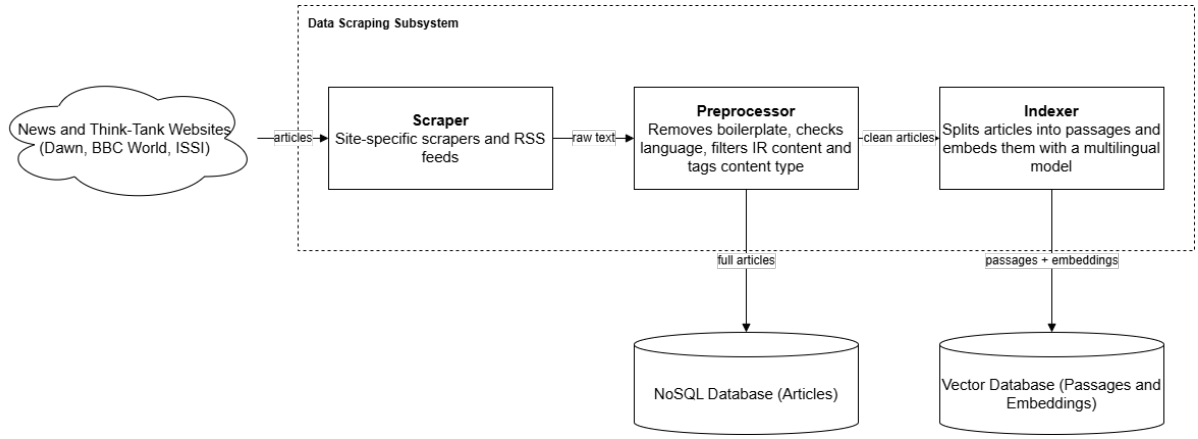


Figure 6.2: Data Scraping - Subsystem Architecture Diagram

This figure represents the Data Scraping and Knowledge Base subsystem.

6.3.2 Cold-Start Profiling

The Cold-Start Profiling subsystem consists of the question selector, the answer recorder and the group assigner. The question selector picks onboarding questions from the question bank, asking first the questions that best separate the groups. The answer recorder saves each answer as soon as it is given, so that an interrupted quiz can be resumed. The group assigner updates the score of each group after every answer and, once one group clearly leads or about ten questions have been asked, stores the learner's language and depth in their profile. The structure of this subsystem is shown in Figure 6.3.

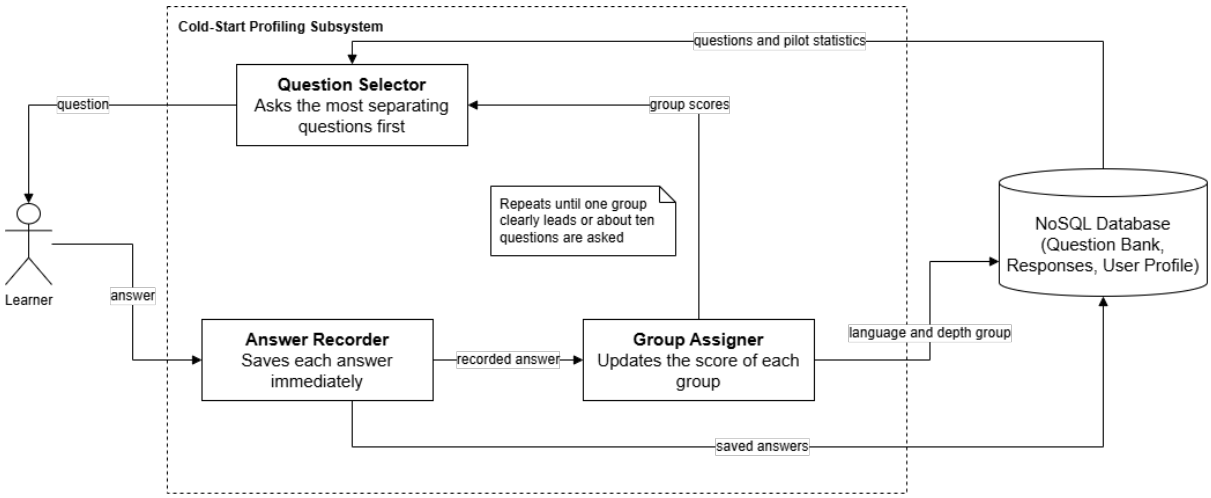


Figure 6.3: Cold-Start Profiling - Subsystem Architecture Diagram

This figure represents the Cold-Start Profiling subsystem.

6.3.3 Content Adaptation

The Content Adaptation subsystem has four major components: the retriever, the adapter selector, the generator and the formatter. The retriever searches the vector database for passages related to the question, re-ranks them with the language model and keeps only the relevant ones; when the learner enables web search or uploads a document, the web pages or the document text are used as the evidence instead. The adapter selector uses the LinUCB bandit to choose a language adapter and a depth adapter for the learner. The generator combines the two selected adapters with the base model and generates an explanation that uses only the evidence and cites it. Finally, the formatter displays the explanation in the correct script and direction and attaches the source links. The structure of this subsystem is shown in Figure 6.4.

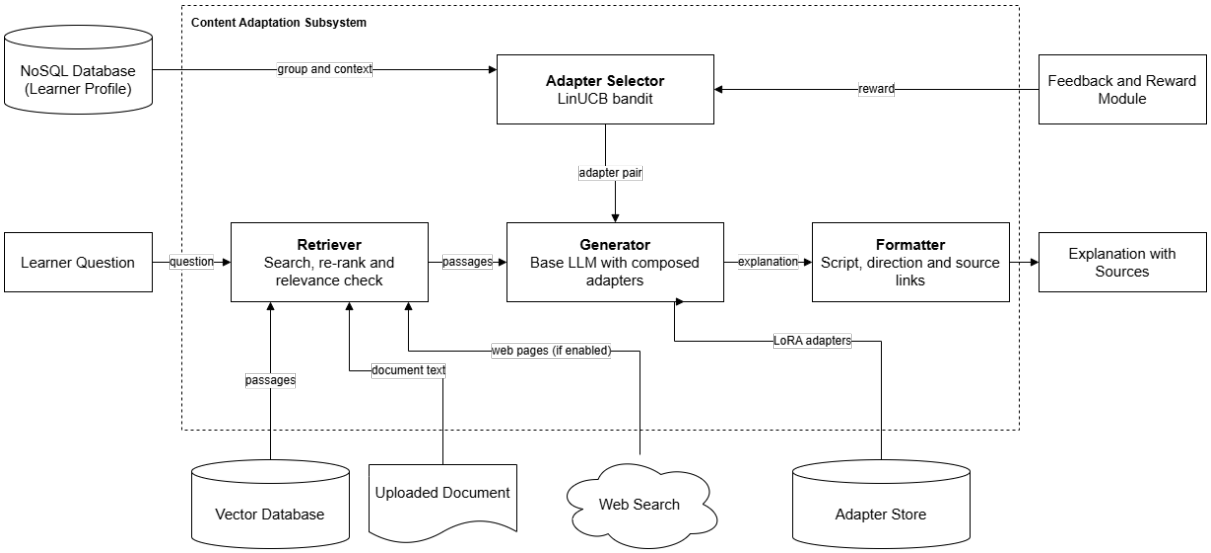


Figure 6.4: Content Adaptation - Subsystem Architecture Diagram

This figure represents the Content Adaptation subsystem.

6.3.4 Feedback and Drift Detection

The Feedback and Drift Detection subsystem consists of the quiz generator, the reward calculator and the drift monitor. The quiz generator creates multiple-choice questions from the learner's recent explanations and discards questions whose answers are not supported by them. The reward calculator scores the learner's answers, uses the score to update the bandit for the adapter pair that was used, and stores the result in the database. The drift monitor compares the learner's recent rewards with the rewards of their group and moves the learner to a better-suited neighbouring group when needed. The stored results are also used periodically to improve the shared adapters. The structure of this subsystem is shown in Figure 6.5.

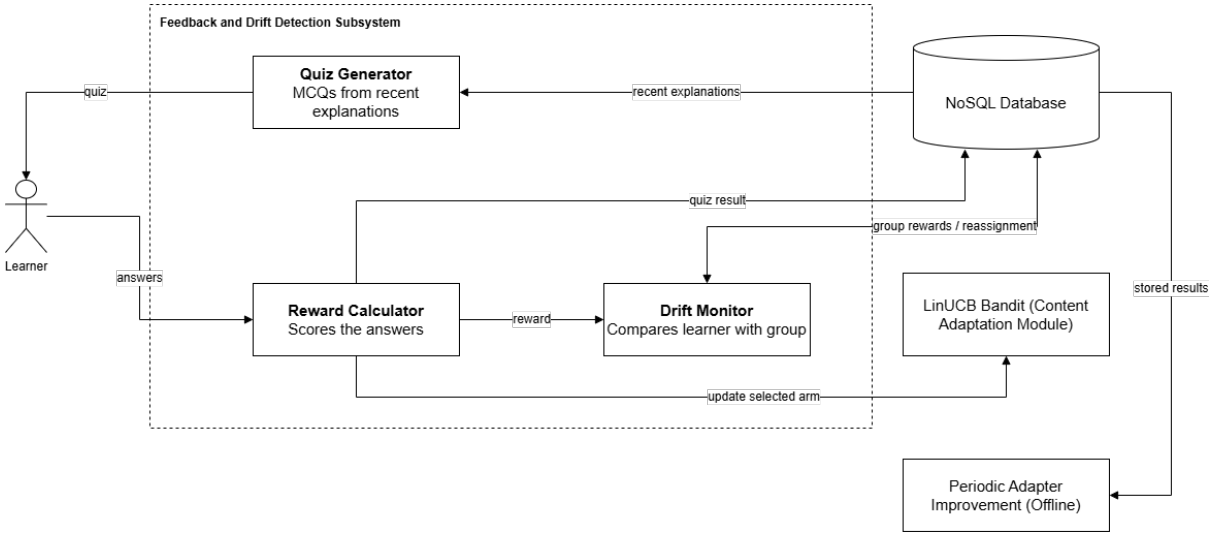


Figure 6.5: Feedback and Drift Detection - Subsystem Architecture Diagram

This figure represents the Feedback and Drift Detection subsystem.

6.4 Architectural Strategies

The architectural strategies that we will be using for DiploMind are given below.

6.4.1 Tools and Software

The backend of DiploMind will be developed in Python using FastAPI. The language and depth adapters will be trained and combined using PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers and PEFT on an open base model such as Llama-3-8B or Mistral-7B, with training carried out in Jupyter and Kaggle notebooks. For retrieval, a multilingual embedding model such as BGE-M3 or Jina Embeddings v4 will be used with a vector database and BM25 keyword search. Requests, BeautifulSoup and RSS feed parsers will be used to build the scrapers, and Tesseract OCR will be used to extract text from scanned documents. Git and GitHub will be used for version control and Draw.io for the design diagrams. We use Python for the backend, the scraping, and the machine learning, so all the parts of the system fit together easily.

6.4.2 Client-Server Model

DiploMind uses a client server setup. The web interface talks with backend through API requests and does work like managing sessions, retrieving sources, choosing adapter, and explanantion generation. The interface only sends what user types and shows what comes back. We could add another front end later, like a mobile app with the same backend.

6.4.3 Database

Diplomind uses a NoSQL database like MongoDB for most of the data i.e., users, conversations, messages, articles, the onboarding question bank, and quiz responses. These records will probably keep changing during implementation. In the vector database, the passages and their embeddings will be stored. The reasons for choosing a NoSQL database are discussed further in Section 6.7.2.

6.4.4 Adapter-Based Personalization

Instead of training a separate model for each of the nine groups, DiploMind uses one shared base model with six small LoRA adapters: three for language and three for depth. For each request, the selected language adapter and depth adapter are combined with the base model by weighted addition, which produces nine different behaviours from only six adapters. This reduces the training and memory cost, and a new language or depth level can be added by training a single new adapter.

6.4.5 Retrieval-Augmented Generation

The facts used in explanations are kept in the knowledge base and retrieved for every question, instead of being learned into the model itself. This allows new articles to be added by the scraping pipeline without retraining the model, and allows every explanation to show its sources. The adapters therefore only control how the explanation is written, not what it says.

6.4.6 Interface Paradigms

The interface is a plain chat screen, which keeps it similar for users of all levels of expertise. Everything happens in the same conversation, questions, explanations, source links and short quiz after 5 to 10 questions. Uploading a document, searching the web, and changing the language are available on chat screen. Urdu text appears from right to left and English stays left to right in their normal form.

6.4.7 Future Plans for Extension

For the future, voice based interaction and production scale deployment can be added to make the system more easy for the users to use. More adapters can be trained to support more languages or depths. A mobile application can also be built on the existing backend. A bandit that gives less weight to old feedback may be explored so that the system adapts more quickly.

6.5 Domain Model/Class Diagram

Figure 6.6 is the class diagram of DiploMind. It shows the main data classes in the system and how they connect to each other. A User owns many Conversation objects, each of which contains many Message objects that cite the Article passages they were generated from. Learners also submit responses to the onboarding questions and to the quizzes taken during a conversation.

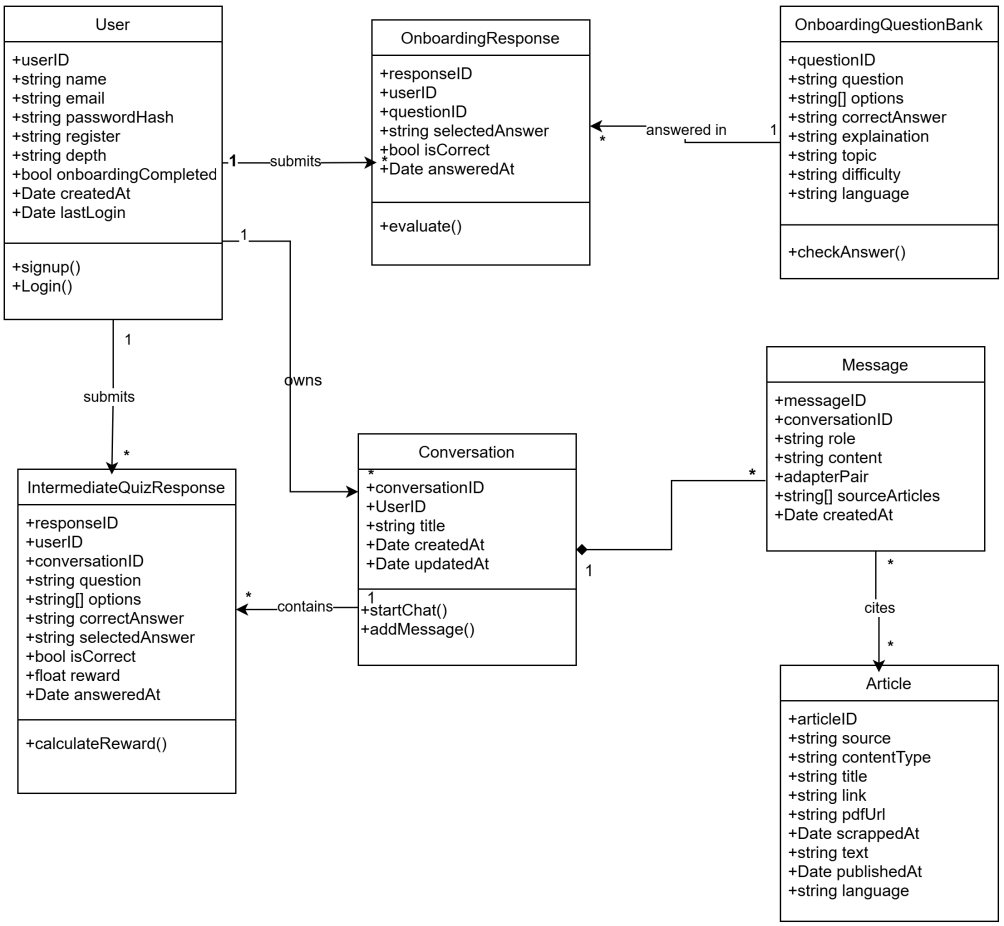


Figure 6.6: Class diagram

6.6 Sequence Diagrams

A sequence diagram is a type of UML (Unified Modeling Language) diagram that shows how the parts of a system interact over time to carry out a task. Each participant is drawn as a lifeline, messages between participants are drawn as arrows in the order they occur, and activation bars show when a participant is busy handling a request. Solid arrows represent requests and dashed arrows represent responses, while framed regions mark alternative paths (*alt*), optional steps (*opt*), repeated steps (*loop*) and early exits (*break*). The learner is the only actor in DiploMind, so the following figures cover every flow that a

learner starts, from registration and onboarding to asking questions, taking quizzes and managing chats.

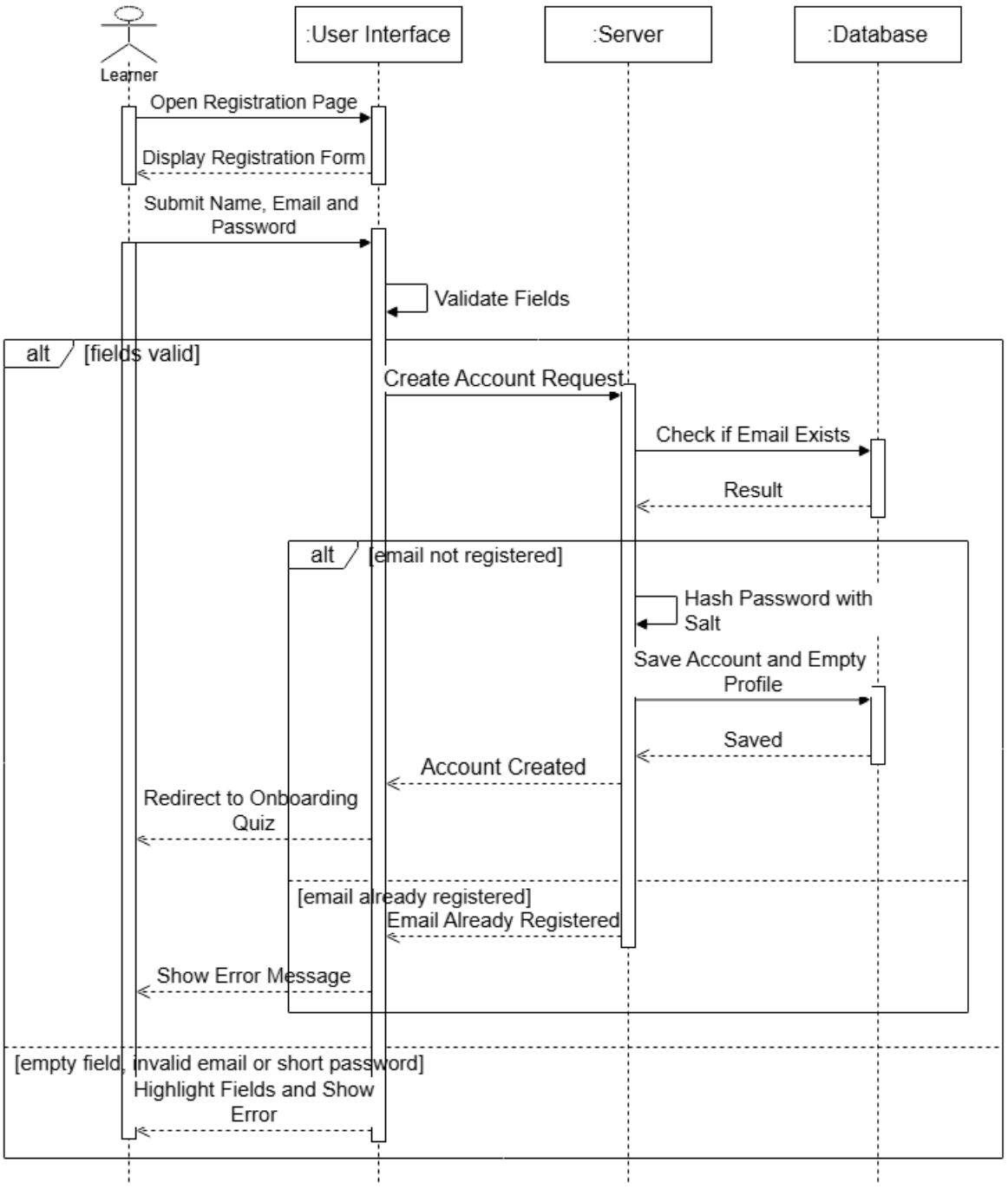


Figure 6.7: Sequence of User Registration

Flow/Sequence of operations followed by the system when a new learner creates an account.

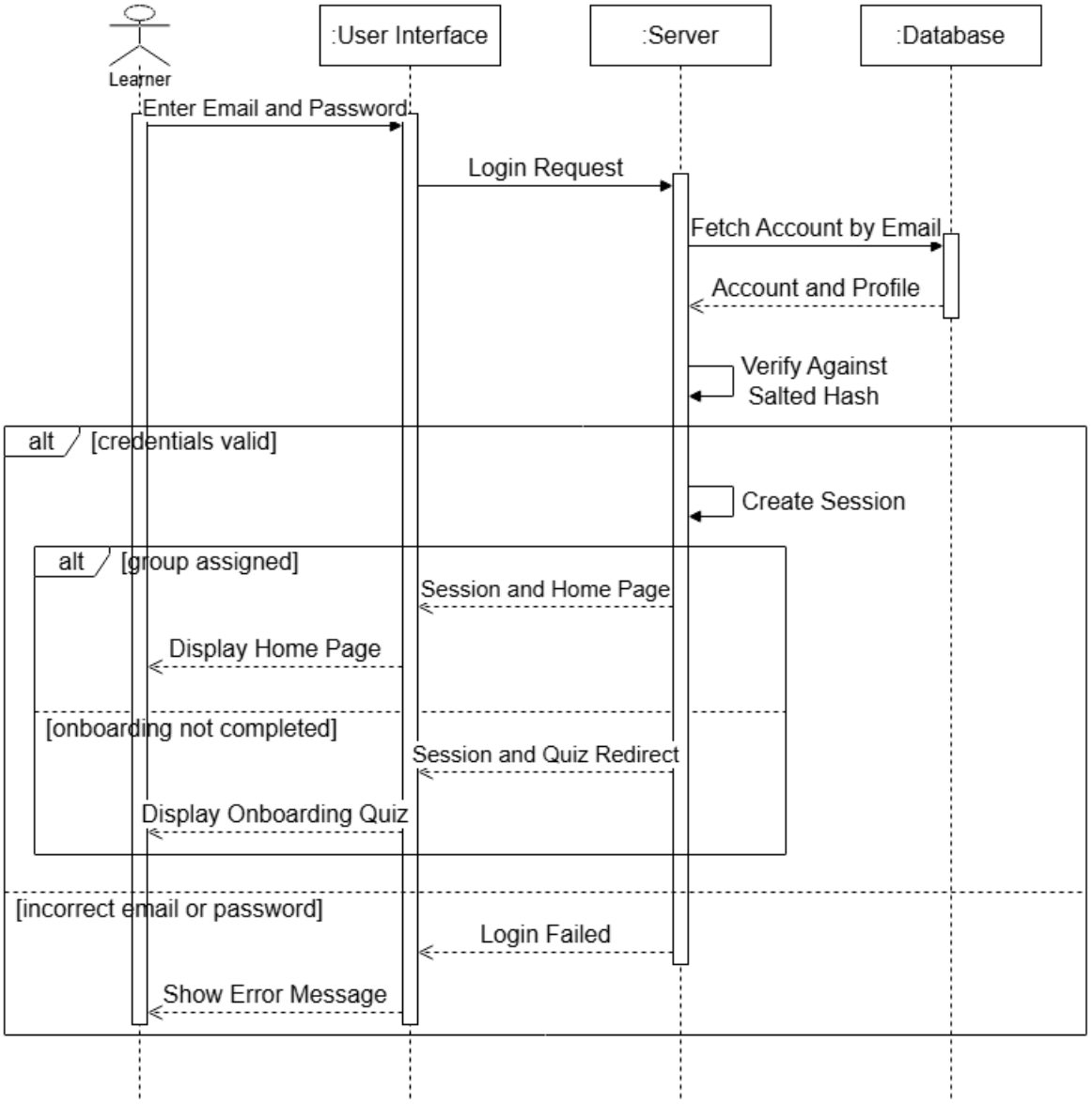


Figure 6.8: Sequence of User Login

Flow/Sequence of operations followed by the system when a learner signs in, including redirection to the onboarding quiz.

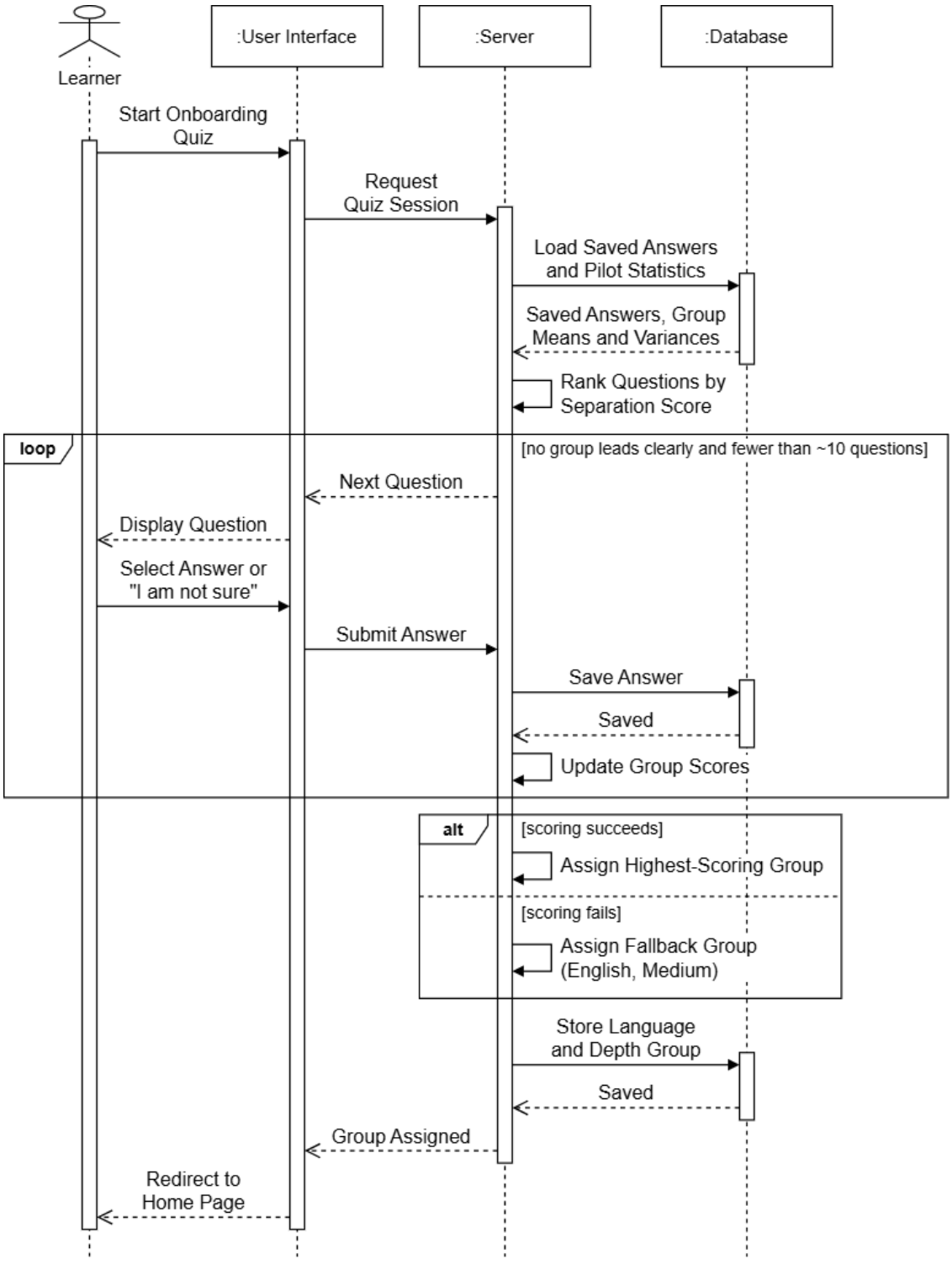


Figure 6.9: Sequence of Onboarding Quiz

Flow/Sequence of operations followed by the system to place a new learner into one of the nine language and depth groups.

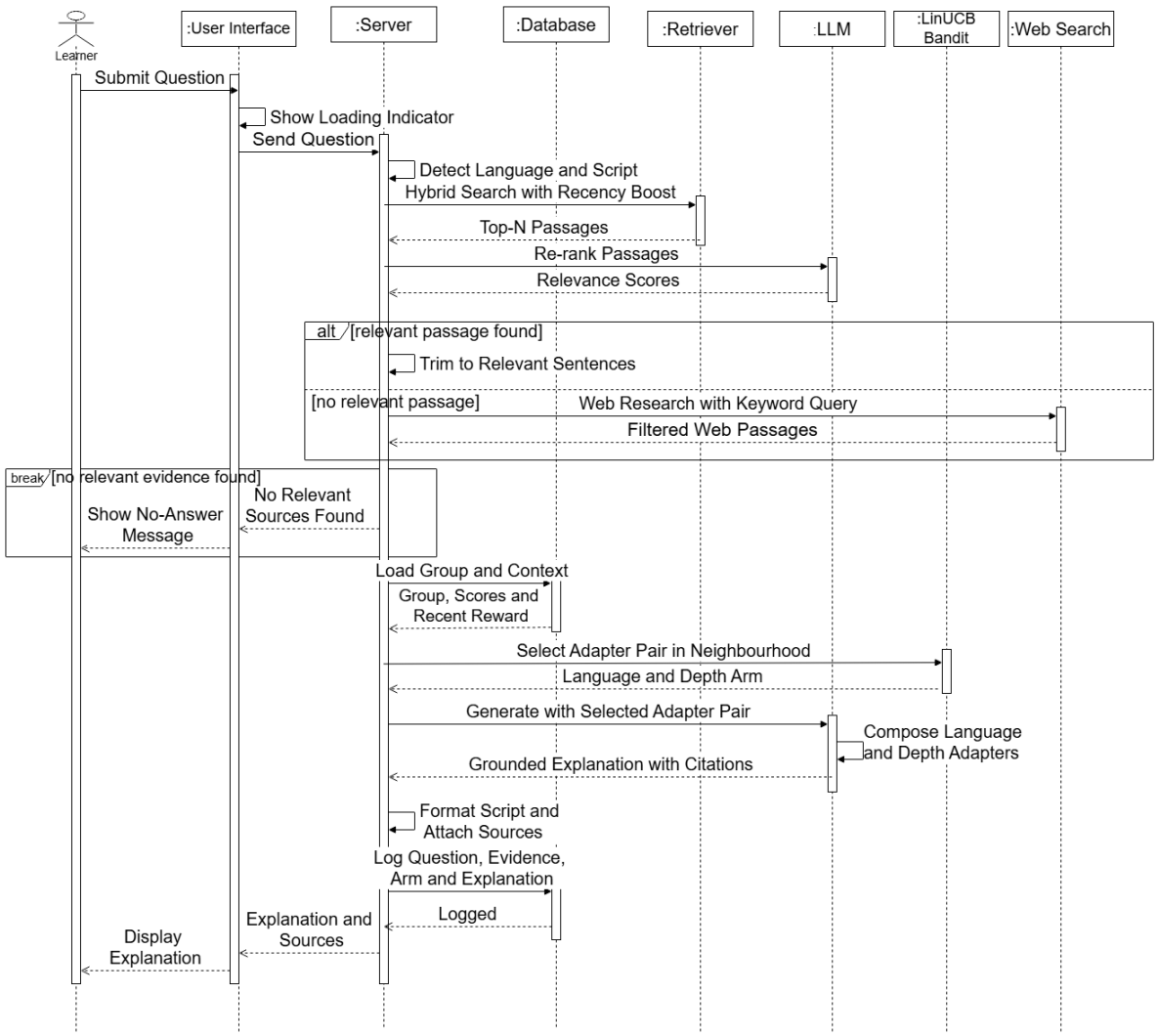


Figure 6.10: Sequence of Asking a Question

Flow/Sequence of operations followed by the system to retrieve evidence, select an adapter pair and generate a personalized explanation.

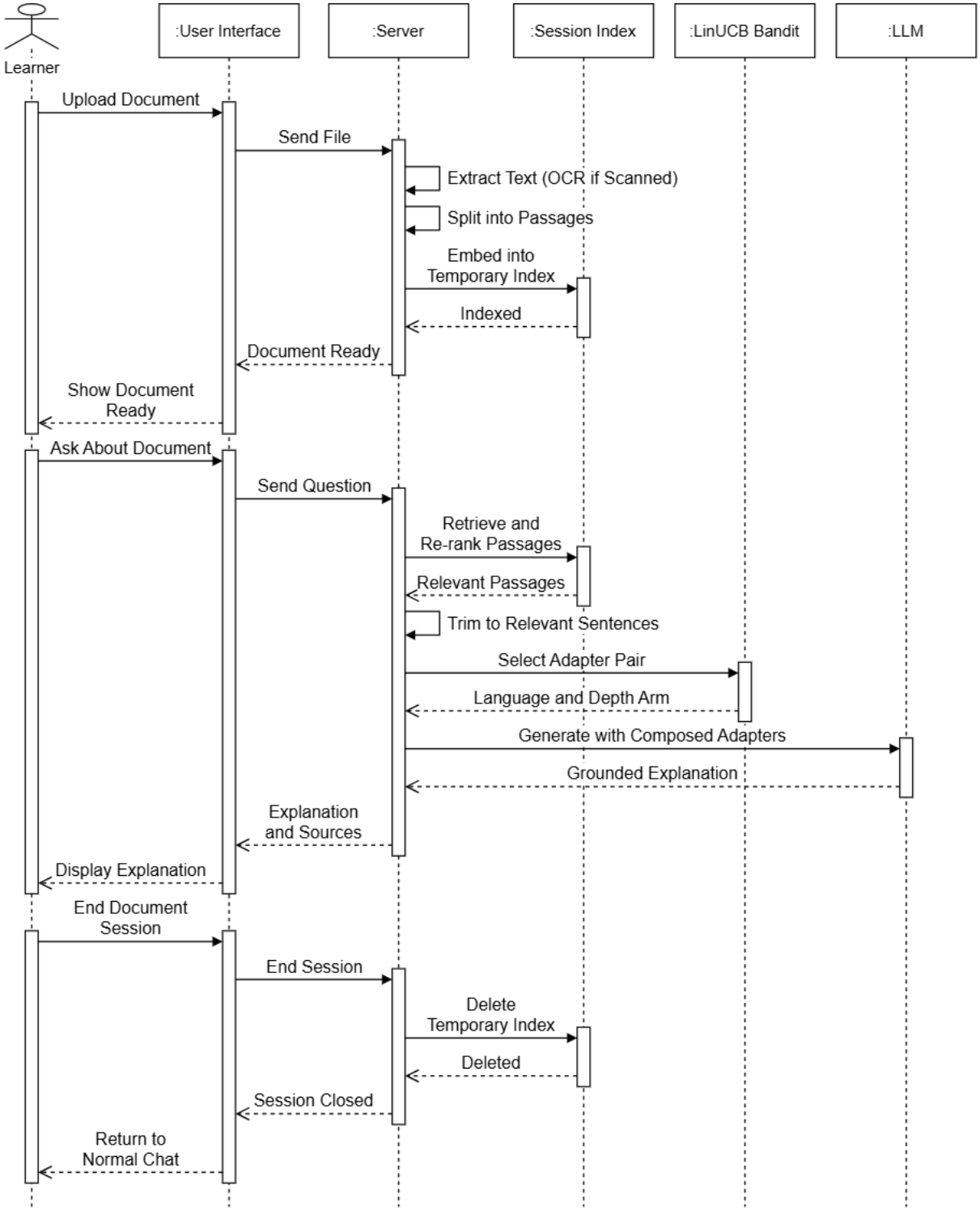


Figure 6.11: Sequence of Document Upload

Flow/Sequence of operations followed by the system to explain a learner's uploaded document through a temporary session index.

6.7 Policies and Tactics

Below are the policies and tactics Diplomind will follow, along with the other options we looked at before settling on them.

6.7.1 Coding Guidelines and Code Organization

The main language of Diplomind is python so the code will stick to PEP 8 and every module and public function will carry a docstring. There are different modules for scraping, retrieval, adapters, bandit, drift monitor so that each module can be built and tested alone and adding a new feature is not an issue. Settings that might need adjusting, such as the composition weights, the exploration parameter, and the drift thresholds, stay in config files rather than inside the code.

6.7.2 Choice of Database

Diplomind uses NoSQL database that stores user profiles, chats, interaction logs and quiz results. These records keep changing as they have sources, adapter pair used, logged fields which will change as reward and bandit are finalized. We thought of using relational database but because it requires rewriting the schema again and again during development we went with NoSQL datbase. The relationships in Diplomind are simple, a user has chats and chats has interactions.

6.7.3 Choice of Algorithms

LinUCB picks adapters based on how unsure it is about each option not picking it at random and thus gave better results than ε greedy exploration when data was limited [7]. Training 9 adapters need more data and addition of new language or depth would mean training another one so for personalization we combine six adapters and combine them with weights. We also rules out personalizing through prompt alone, because earlier research found that prompts can't hold several preferences at once [6]. For onboarding, the adaptive question selection of Shams et al. [14] is preferred.

6.7.4 Safe Exploration and Reassignment

The bandit can only pick user's current adapter pair or move to one right beside it, meaning one depth step up or down, or another language at the same depth. The exploration setting begins small. Full freedom to explore was dropped as an option, since a beginner could get a technical explanation purely because the system wanted to try something out. A user's group can be changed only when the nearby group works clearly better for them. After every change, the system waits for a while before it can move them again, so they don't keep getting switched.

6.7.5 Grounding and Source Policy

The model doesn't answer from memory. It only works with what it finds, and it shows where that came from. If the knowledge base has nothing useful, and the web search turns up nothing either, the learner gets told straight out. No guessing. International relations is political and changes all the time, so one old or wrong claim could really mislead someone. That's the whole reason. And when we do search the web, we stick to news and analysis sites people already trust, not random pages.

6.7.6 Data Handling and Privacy

Each user should only see his own profile and the passwords should be stored as salted hashes for privacy. If someone uploads a document, it stays in a temporary place until the session ends, then it gets deleted. It never goes into the main knowledge base. The logs we use to improve the adapters have no names or email addresses in them. Scraped articles are used for research only and paywalled content is excluded.

6.7.7 User Interface

For every type of user, especially users with no tech knowledge the interface will be simple and easy to use. Urdu is displayed right to left, English left to right, and Urdish in English letter. Every explanation will also show its source. While the explanation is being generated a loading sign is shown for the user and in case of quizzes the user will be given an "I am not sure" option so that they are not forced to guess.

6.7.8 Testing

We will write small unit tests for onboarding scoring, bandit updates, reward calculation and drift rules. After that we will test run the whole question flow to make sure it works from start to end. Each use case will be tested by hand. In start there are very few users, so pretend users will be used to test the bandit and drift monitor. Some of them will be put in the wrong group for testing drift detection. People who speak Urdu and Urdish will review the explanations. And the adapters will be tested on set of questions they were not trained on.

6.7.9 Engineering Trade-offs

A few trade offs shaped how we build this. A 7-8B model in 4 bit fits on a 16 GB GPU, but the answers are a bit weaker than a bigger model would give. Using LLM to re rank passages gives better evidence, but it makes answer slower. After every 5 to 10 prompts a quiz gives the bandit a reward signal, and asking more often would tire the user. Native speakers found roman script more natural for Urdish [16],

but there are no standard spellings for this script so reviewing this is very difficult. For slow improvement loop, reward filtered tuning goes first because it's easiest.

6.8 Conclusion

This chapter covered the design of Diplomind. It started with an introduction of what Diplomind is and what it does, then explained its assumptions, dependencies, constraints, and guidelines. It explains the architecture which is divided into offline preparation part and online part where users use the system. The reason for using one shared model and six adapters was also explained alongwith retrieval augmented generation, client server setup, and a NoSQL database with vector database. What a user can do is shown through the sequence diagrams, and the policies and tactics list our choices on algorithms, safe exploration, grounding, privacy and testing.

Chapter 7 Experimental Results and Discussion

This chapter reports the experimentation involving the base Model selection along with the training and evaluation of the six LoRA adapters of Diplomind i.e. three language adapters (Urdu, Urdish, English) and three depth adapters (easy, medium, technical). The base model selection involved running 4 candidate models on the same samples and then reviewing the quality of them using automated language following checks as well as human reviews. Each adapter was trained on its own training set and evaluated against the base model on a fixed test set. The chapter describes the experimental setup and the evaluation metrics, presents the model selection findings, training behaviour and test results of each adapter and discusses what the results show and where they are limited.

7.1 Experimentation Overview

The experiment covered three parts. The first one compared four candidate models without any finetuning, to help choose the base for which all adapters would be trained (Section 7.2). The second part covered whether a small LoRA adapter can teach a model to follow tone or language instuctions, and whether composing two adapters trained for different task gave the behavior of both. The third and final part compared the composition approach with the jointly trained approach to verify that composing adapters give almost similar performance as jointly training them. The following questions form the basis of our experimentation:

- Which of the four candidate models already handles Urdu and Urdish best, without any finetuning?
- Does each adapter lower the loss of the base model on unseen articles?
- Does the adapted model follow the requested language or depth more consistently than the base model?
- Does the adapter keep the output faithful to the source article (names, numbers and facts unchanged)?
- Does composing two (or more) adapters using simple mathematical operations gives us a middleground of both?
- Does the composing work in a way that the performance is almost identical with joint adapters but cost is cut due to less adapters being trained?

The base model comparison selected Llama 3.1 8B Instruct, and all six adapters were trained on it. Every adapter was trained with the same configuration so that differences between adapters come from their training data and not from their settings. All adapter results are measured on the same test articles.

The base model comparison was run before any training and used its own small set of test inputs, which is described in Section 7.2.

7.2 Base Model Selection

Before training the adapters, a major task was to choose a base model, the base model selection relied on which model generated our required language (and depth) more clearly even without seeing any sample or finetuning. We compared for open sourced LLMs, all ranging in the size of 7 Billion to 12 Billion parameters. These models were: Llama 3.1 8B Instruct, Qwen3 8B, Mistral 7B Instruct v0.3 and Gemma 3 12B. At the time of this experimentation, the dataset wasn't ready so we used a small, fixed set of news inputs to test on.

7.2.1 Setup

Each model received the same 33 prompts, split across two tasks. All prompts were zero-shot, which means that the prompts only described the tasks and didn't include any example answers at all.

7.2.1.1 Generation Task

The first task revolved around generating the type of explanations DiploMind is expected to generate, i.e. explaining a news item in the language and depth the users want. We took three english news paragraphs on Pakistani and IR content and asked each model to explain every summary in all nine combinations of language and depth, giving 27 prompts per model. The exact wording of of each prompt is given in Table 7.1.

7.2.1.2 Urdu Comprehension Task

The second task judged the LLMs understanding of urdu source text, which we needed as many of our article sources are in Urdu as well. Each model was given six Urdu news articles and was asked to summarise each one in English in three to five sentences, keeping names and numbers exactly as in the article. The exact wording of of the prompt is given in Table 7.2.

7.2.1.3 Prompts

Every prompt had a system message and a user message. For the generation task, the system message combined a fixed role with one language instruction and one depth instruction, and the user message contained the news summary. For the understanding task, the system message included the role of the

model and the user message asked for the summary of the news source attached. Table 7.1 and Table 7.2 lists prompts for both of these tasks.

Table 7.1: Prompt templates for the generation task. The system message is the role sentence followed by one language instruction and one depth instruction

Part	Text
System (role)	You explain international-relations news to readers in Pakistan.
Language: English	Write your answer in English.
Language: Urdish	Write your answer in Urdish: Urdu written in English (Roman) letters, mixed with English words, the way Pakistanis write in text messages (for example: "Hukumat ne naya faisla kiya hai"). Do not use Urdu script.
Language: Urdu	Write your answer in Urdu, using Urdu script.
Depth: easy	Explain it for a complete beginner: short, simple sentences, and explain any technical term in plain words.
Depth: medium	Explain it for an interested general reader, like a university student from another field.
Depth: hard	Explain it like an analyst writing for specialists: precise technical vocabulary, no explanations of terms.
User	Explain this news: *[news summary]*

Table 7.2: Prompt template for the Urdu comprehension task

Part	Text
System	You are a careful reader of Urdu news.
User	Read this Urdu news article and summarise its main facts in 3 to 5 English sentences. Keep names and numbers exact. *[Urdu article]*

For example, the system message for an easy Urdish explanation was the role sentence, followed by the Urdish instruction, followed by the easy depth instruction.

7.2.1.4 Settings and Metrics

For the setup and generation, the models were loaded one at a time in 4-bit quantization on a single Kaggle T4 GPU. Answers were generated greedily, iterating over the prompts one by one, with a generation limit of 400 tokens to prevent unnecessary long outputs. The outputs were scored with the following metrics:

Language adherence: Whether the output is in the requested language and script. It was checked with simple language based rules that checked on the basis of urdu script characters and roman urdu words.
Hindi leakage: Whether the output contains Devanagari characters.
Number recall: The share of numbers in the source that also appear in the output, as a simple check on facts.
Urdu tokenizer fertility: How many tokens were needed to represent a word. The lower the better since longer token sequences make training and inference more costly.

Generation speed: Tokens generated per second on the T4 GPU.

7.2.2 Results

After running all 33 prompts on each model, we scored the outputs using the metrics described above. Table 7.3 summarises the results.

Table 7.3: Zero-shot comparison of the candidate models

Model	English	Urdish	Urdu	Hindi	Num. rec.	Urdu fert.	Tok/s
Llama 3.1 8B	9/9	**9/9**	8/9	0/33	83%	2.95	10.9
Qwen3 8B	9/9	5/9	9/9	0/33	80%	3.06	9.2
Mistral 7B	9/9	6/9	5/9	7/33	97%	4.65	12.8
Gemma 3 12B	9/9	5/9	9/9	0/33	59%	**1.39**	8.7

All four models followed the English instruction. Urdish is what created a distinction for us to judge the quality most clearly. Llama was the only model to get it right every time, while Qwen and Gemma often replied in English instead of Roman Urdu. Mistral had the weakest Urdu, sometimes wrote Urdish in Urdu script and was the only model to leak Hindi in its outputs. It still had a high number recall along with this weak urdu, showing that high number recall doesn't mean better answer quality. Gemma had the most efficient Urdu tokenizer, using about half as many tokens as Llama to represent the same text. In English, all four models wrote at a higher reading grade as the requested depth increased, so all of them followed the depth instruction.

7.2.3 Output Comparison

The scores in Table 7.3 Can be misleading as we've seen in an example above that high recall due to rule based checks doesn't necessarily mean that the quality is good and consistent with the language. So we reviewed the outputs ourselves and also took help of our peers to judge which one is actually consistent. In this section we first compare the four models on the same news item in Urdish and in Urdu, and then show the main kinds of errors we found in Qwen, Mistral and Gemma. All examples in Table 7.4 and Table 7.5 are answers to the following news summary at the easy depth:

> Protests against the emergency and governor's rule in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa continued for a second day in the Bara area of Khyber district, with markets closed and a heavy police and FC presence. According to Peshawar police, 21 people, including police personnel, were injured in clashes between police and PTI workers on 13 October, and 62 people were taken into custody.

7.2.3.1 Urdish

Table 7.4 shows the answers of the four models for the Urdish prompt. Llama's answer is short, natural and keeps all three numbers (13 October, 21 injured, 62 arrested). Qwen understood the news but ignored the language instruction and wrote in English. Mistral passed the automatic check, but its Urdish is hard to read and uses hallucinated phrases such as "shamshir-e-qayamat" for the emergency, which shows that the rule based check cannot judge quality. Gemma's Urdish was natural, but it opened with an English sentence addressed to the user, used different formatting, and its full answer (250 words) was much longer than what a beginner level explanation needs.

Table 7.4: Outputs of the four models for the same prompt (Urdish, easy). Long answers are shortened, marked with [. . .]

Model	Output	Check
Llama 3.1 8B	Hukumat ne Bara area mein emergency ke khilaf protest ko rokne ke liye police aur FC ko bheja hai. 13 October ko police aur PTI workers ke beech ladai hui, jismein 21 log, jismein police ke log bhi shamil the, injured hue. 62 logon ko giraftaar kiya gaya hai.	Passed
Qwen3 8B	People are protesting in Khyber area again. They are against the emergency and the governor's rule. Markets are closed. Police and FC are there in big numbers. On 13th October, there was a fight between police and PTI workers. [. . .]	Failed (plain English)
Mistral 7B	Aaj kal, Bara khuwahish ke khudutay hukumat mein shamshir-e-qayamat aur wali-e-wazarat (governor's rule) ke tarkib par dharna-e-azadi (protests) do din baad rahay hain Khyber Pakhtunkhwa mein [. . .]	Passed
Gemma 3 12B	Okay, here's an explanation of the news, written in a style a Pakistani might use in a text message [. . .] "Acha, suno. KP mein, Khyber district ke Bara area mein protests chal rahe hain. Governor's Rule lagaya gaya hai, isliye log protest kar rahe hain." [. . .]	Passed

7.2.3.2 Urdu

Table 7.5 shows the answers of the four models for the same news in Urdu. All four answers passed the automatic Urdu check, but reading them shows what went wrong with which model. Llama's answer keeps all the facts and numbers and is easy to follow, although a few word choices are weird, such as *dhansne wali soorat-e-haal*. Qwen's answer has the right structure but it replaced the place name with an unrelated word (*kichri*), used the meaningless phrase *swamiyon ke market*, and turned governor's rule

into “the governor’s order”. Mistral’s answer is the hardest to read, it says the 21 people became ill instead of injured, and the sentences are not grammatically correct. Gemma wrote the most fluent Urdu, but it started by talking to the user, formatted the answer with markdown headings and bullet points (removed in the table), used the unusual term *aaftein haalat* for emergency, and added a claim that is not in the source that the Chief Minister got suspended.

Table 7.5: Outputs of the four models for the same prompt (Urdu, easy). Long answers are shortened, marked with [. . .]

Model	Output	Check
Llama 3.1 8B	کھیبر پختونخواہ کے بارہ علاقے میں ایک دھنسنے والی صورتحال ہے۔ وہاں کے لوگ حکومت کے خلاف احتجاج کر رہے ہیں۔ [...] 13 اکتوبر کو پولیس اور PTI کے کارکنوں کے درمیان جھڑپوں میں 21 افراد، جن میں پولیس کے افراد بھی شامل ہیں، زخمی ہوئے۔ 62 افراد کو گرفتار کر لیا گیا ہے۔	Passed
Qwen3 8B	کچھ لوگ کیچڑی کے علاقے میں ایک دوسرے روز مظاہرہ جاری رکھے ہوئے ہیں۔ یہ مظاہرہ حکومت کی ایمرجنسی اور گورنر کے حکم کے خلاف ہے۔ اس دوران سوامیوں کے مارکیٹ بند ہو گئے ہیں۔ [...]	Passed
Mistral 7B	[...] پشاور پولیس کے مطابق، 13 اکتوبر کے دن پولیس و پاکستان تیزی ایکس کارکردگاروں کے درمیان جرم ہوئے تھے جن میں 21 شخص شامل پولیس کارکردگار بیمار ہوئے تھے اور 62 شخص درج کی گئے تھے۔	Passed
Gemma 3 12B	ٹھیک ہے، میں آپ کو اس خبر کے بارے میں بتاتا ہوں۔ [...] خبر کیا ہے؟ [...] KPK میں ایک آفتیں حالت نافذ کی گئی ہے۔ [...] اس کا مطلب ہے کہ صوبے کے وزیر اعلیٰ کو معطل کر دیا گیا ہے [...]	Passed

7.2.3.3 Errors in the Other Models

Apart from the examples above, we found some problems in Qwen, Mistral and Gemma. Table 7.6 shows one example of each, taken from other prompts in the comparison.

These examples show that the weaker results in Table 7.3 come from different kinds of problems. Qwen tended to fall back to English and, in one case, got stuck in a repetition loop. Mistral’s problems were with the Urdu language,with it using wrong words, wrong script and Hindi letters. Gemma understood the task and wrote fluently, but it did not stick to the format and added extra information. Llama also made some mistakes, but its answers stayed in the requested language and kept closer to the source than the others.

Table 7.6: Examples of errors made by Qwen, Mistral and Gemma

Model	Prompt	Output (shortened)	Problem
Qwen3 8B	Urdish, hard	[. . .] 13 October ko police aur PTI workers ke beech clash mein 21 log, jo ki police ke log bhi shamil hain, zara zara zara zara zara zara zara zara zara [. . .]	Got stuck repeating one word until the output limit
Qwen3 8B	Urdish, hard	Russia's Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov mentioned during a speech to students in Moscow on 7 September that Iran could potentially join the Makkah Defence Agreement [. . .]	Plain English, and added its own analysis not in the source
Mistral 7B	Urdish, hard	حکومت نے نئے فیصلہ کیا ہے کہ خیبر پختونخوا کے برا انداز کے خیبر ضلع میں دوسری روز اپنا اعتراض ادا رہا ہے [...]	Wrote Urdish in Urdu script (all three hard prompts)
Mistral 7B	Urdu, easy	پاکستان کا فیدرل سرکار کہتا ہے کہ امریکا مقرونہ سے فرائض کے بعد اپنے 10 بیلیون ڈولر کے Exchange Stabilisation Facility کو پوزیٹیف اتمام کرنا ممکن ہے۔ [...]	Spelled the name Aurangzeb with Hindi (Devanagari) letters mixed into the Urdu spelling
Gemma 3 12B	Urdish, hard	Okay, here's an explanation of the Lavrov statement [. . .] **Please read the disclaimer at the very end** [. . .] Okay guys, listen up. Lavrov's comment about Iran potentially joining the Makkah Initiative – it's *significant*, but needs unpacking. [. . .]	Mostly English, with a long preamble and a disclaimer

7.2.4 Selected Model

We chose **Llama 3.1 8B Instruct** as our base model, primarily because Urdish was a risky target and Llama was the only model that handled it better than the others. It also performed close to best in Urdu and kept the source information without hallucinating any facts. Gemma wrote consistent Urdu and Urdish but the checks failed due to surrounding text in other script. It also would need more GPU power to finetune since it has more parameters than Llama. Llama's drawback is its tokenizer which would make training expensive but it is not that big of an issue since it would still fit the A4000 GPU we would be finetuning on.

7.2.5 Limitations

This comparison used only 33 prompts per model, so small differences (such as 8/9 against 9/9) should not be over read. The checks are rule based and do not measure fluency, and some long outputs were cut off at the 400 token limit. The before/after evaluation of the trained adapters in the following sections gives a more direct test of whether Llama was a good choice.

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